

Video scripts

30 Days DPDP Act

Narration for all 30 training videos. Lessons, quizzes, and the final exam are not included.

Last reviewed: 2 October 2026

This course is educational. It is not legal advice, a government certification, or a statement that Consent Guru is a Consent Manager registered with the Data Protection Board. Check the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025, and the Official Gazette before you rely on a compliance decision. Content last reviewed on 2 October 2026.

Contents

- 01 Introduction to Data Protection and Privacy
- 02 Introduction to the DPDP Act 2023
- 03 Key Definitions and Terminology
- 04 Applicability and Territorial Scope
- 05 Personal Data and Digital Personal Data
- 06 Data Principal
- 07 Data Fiduciary
- 08 Data Processor
- 09 Consent under the DPDP Act
- 10 Notice and Transparency Requirements
- 11 Lawful Purpose, Specified Purpose, and Certain Legitimate Uses
- 12 Processing of Children's Data
- 13 Rights of Data Principals
- 14 Right to Access Information
- 15 Correction and Erasure
- 16 Grievance Redressal
- 17 Nomination Rights
- 18 Duties of Data Principals
- 19 Obligations of Data Fiduciaries
- 20 Security Safeguards and Personal Data Breaches
- 21 Data Breach Management and Notification
- 22 Significant Data Fiduciaries
- 23 Additional Obligations of Significant Data Fiduciaries
- 24 Data Protection Board of India
- 25 Penalties and Enforcement
- 26 Cross-Border Data Transfers
- 27 Data Retention, Deletion and Lifecycle Management
- 28 Consent Management and Practical CMP Implementation
- 29 Building a DPDP Compliance Program
- 30 DPDP Compliance in Real-World Organizations - Final Practical Module

Module 01**Introduction to Data Protection and Privacy**

About 12 minutes

1

A product manager opens a signup form and asks for a name, a mobile number, and a city. That ordinary screen is a privacy decision, because the person filling the form is trusting the organisation with information that can identify her. India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 is Act 22 of 2023, and it received Presidential assent on 11 August 2023. This opening module explains why digital personal data needs a shared workplace standard. It also draws a line that later modules will keep: the course teaches the enacted law and the commencement dates, and it is not legal advice for a live dispute.

2

Think about a clinic that stores appointment notes on a laptop, a shop that saves a delivery address, and a hiring portal that keeps a résumé. Each team may use different software, but each is handling information about a person. Privacy training fails when it stays abstract. It works when people can point to the record they actually touch. In this course the person the data is about is the Data Principal, and the organisation that decides why and how the data is processed is the Data Fiduciary. Those labels come from section 2, which is already in force.

3

Assent and commencement answer different questions. Assent on 11 August 2023 made the Act law. Commencement is the date a provision starts to operate. Section 1 lets the Central Government appoint different dates for different provisions. Notification G.S.R. 843(E) dated 13 November 2025 does that. A payroll manager who says the whole Act started in August 2023 is mixing the two events. The useful habit is to ask which section is being discussed, and which date that notification gave it.

4

The notification uses three dates that this course will repeat. On 13 November 2025 it commenced section 1(2), the definitions in section 2, the Board provisions in sections 18 to 26, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and (3). On 13 November 2026 it commences the Consent Manager registration layer in section 6(9) and section 27(1)(d). On 13 May 2027 it commences the operational core: application, notice, consent apart from registration, certain legitimate uses, children's rules, rights, fiduciary duties, cross-border restrictions, and the penalty provisions.

5

The course review date is 2 October 2026. Picture a leadership meeting on that day. Definitions can already be used, because section 2 is in force. The Data Protection Board's institutional provisions are also in force. Consent Manager registration has not started. A vendor who offers to register the company as a Consent Manager on that day is ahead of the statute. Notice, consent standards, children's duties, rights requests, breach intimation, and Schedule penalties are enacted, and they are not yet being enforced.

6

A common workplace mistake is to import a foreign privacy slogan and treat it as Indian law. The DPDP Act has its own grounds for processing. It uses consent under section 6, or certain legitimate uses under section 7, for a lawful purpose under section 4. It does not copy a general legitimate-interest test from another statute. If a slide in your old pack says a business interest alone is enough, park that slide. This course will use the Act's words, and it will say when a provision is still

waiting for 13 May 2027.

7

Preparation is still useful before a duty is in force. A retailer can list the digital personal data it holds, name who decides the purpose, and draft a notice in plain language. Those steps are recommendations. They are not proof that the operational sections are already live. On 2 October 2026 a sensible privacy owner says: we are building the habits now, and we will match them to the sections that commence on 13 May 2027. That sentence is more accurate than a poster that says enforcement has already begun.

8

Close this module by separating three layers. The statutory layer is the Act as enacted, including Act number 22 of 2023 and assent on 11 August 2023. The commencement layer is Notification G.S.R. 843(E), with the Rules, 2025 notified the same day under G.S.R. 846(E). The practical layer is what your team chooses to do early, labelled as a recommendation. A customer-support lead who remembers those three layers will not tell a caller that a penalty is already due. This module is education, not a legal opinion.

Module 02**Introduction to the DPDP Act 2023**

About 14 minutes

1

Put the statute in one sentence before you put it in a project plan. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 is Act 22 of 2023, and it received Presidential assent on 11 August 2023. It is the Indian law on digital personal data. A project plan that starts with the product feature, and never names the Act, will drift. This module is the map. It shows which chapters are already switched on, and which chapters are waiting. The map is educational. It is not a legal opinion on your contract.

2

Section 1 is easy to skip because it looks formal. It is the reason the rest of the calendar exists. It allows the Central Government to bring different provisions into force on different dates by a gazette notification. Notification G.S.R. 843(E) is dated 13 November 2025. If a training deck says the Act is either fully off or fully on, replace that line. A clinic, for example, can already use the statutory definitions, and it cannot yet be told that its notice duty is being enforced.

3

Learn the first tranche as a bundle, not as a blur. On 13 November 2025 the notification commenced section 1(2), section 2, sections 18 to 26, sections 35 and 38 to 43, and section 44(1) and (3). Section 2 gives you the vocabulary: personal data, Data Principal, Data Fiduciary, Data Processor, child, Consent Manager, and personal data breach. Sections 18 to 26 are about establishing the Data Protection Board of India. The same day, G.S.R. 846(E) notified the Rules, 2025, and Rules 1, 2, and 17 to 21 came into force on publication.

4

The second date is easy to miss because it is only two provisions wide. On 13 November 2026, section 6(9) and section 27(1)(d) commence. That is the Consent Manager registration layer, and Rule 4 follows the same one-year timing. A Consent Manager under the Act is a person registered with the Board. On the review date, 2 October 2026, that registration is not yet in force. An agency that calls its cookie banner a registered Consent Manager is using a statutory title the registration layer has not opened.

5

The date that changes daily operations is 13 May 2027. That tranche includes sections 3 to 5, section 6 apart from subsection (9), sections 7 to 17, the rest of section 27, sections 28 to 34, sections 36 and 37, and section 44(2). In plain words, that is when application, notice, consent standards, certain legitimate uses, children, rights, fiduciary obligations, cross-border restrictions, Board enforcement procedure, appeals, and penalties are appointed to commence. Rules 3, 5 to 16, 22, and 23 commence the same day. A retailer preparing a notice is preparing for that date.

6

Now stand on 2 October 2026 and read the map without wishful thinking. Definitions are in force. The Board's establishment provisions are in force. Consent Manager registration is not in force. The duties most teams ask about - the notice, the consent standard, children's data, access and erasure, security and breach intimation, and monetary penalties - are enacted and are not being enforced yet. Say that in the same breath. A leadership slide that lists only the August 2023 assent date will mislead a manager who has to budget for controls.

7

Use the Rules with the same discipline. G.S.R. 846(E) notified the Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 on 13 November 2025. Only Rules 1, 2, and 17 to 21 came into force that day. Rule 4 waits until 13 November 2026. Rules 3, 5 to 16, 22, and 23 wait until 13 May 2027. When someone asks for the prescribed form of a notice or a breach intimation, the honest answer on the review date is that the prescribing rules for those operational duties have not commenced. Do not invent a form to fill the gap.

8

Build a habit you can reuse in every later module. Name the section, name the tranche, and label anything else as a recommendation. For example, a school can draft a parent-consent journey now, and it should say that section 9 commences on 13 May 2027. It should not tell parents that a penalty is already running. Close the conversation by reminding the room that this explanation is training. For a decision that affects a real filing or a real incident, read the Act and the notification, and take qualified advice.

Module 03

Key Definitions and Terminology

About 12 minutes

1

Every later module uses a small set of words, so this module slows down and defines them. The words live in section 2. Notification G.S.R. 843(E) brought section 2 into force on 13 November 2025. On the review date, 2 October 2026, you can already insist on the statutory meaning. What you cannot do is pretend that every duty which uses the word has also started. A useful example is the word breach. The definition is in force. The intimation duty attached to fiduciary obligations waits until 13 May 2027.

2

Start with the thing being protected. Personal data is any data about an individual who is identifiable by or in relation to that data. A name in a spreadsheet can be personal data. A delivery photo that shows a person's face can be personal data. Digital personal data is personal data in digital form. If the record is only on paper and stays on paper, you are not yet in the digital idea this Act regulates. If a clerk later types that paper form into a computer, digitisation is the moment the record joins the digital world.

3

Processing sounds technical and is actually broad. It is a wholly or partly automated operation on digital personal data. Collecting an email address is processing. Storing it is processing. Using it to send a receipt is processing. Sharing it with a courier is processing. Erasing it is processing. A shop that says 'we only store data, we do not process it' is using the everyday word, not section 2. Once you store digital personal data in a system, you are in processing territory for this statute.

4

Name the people before you name the software. The Data Principal is the individual the personal data is about. For a child, that term includes the parent or lawful guardian. For a person with disability, it includes the lawful guardian acting on her behalf. The Act's use of 'her' is a drafting convention, not a limit to one gender. A child is an individual who has not completed eighteen years. A seventeen-year-old applicant on a learning site is a child under section 2, even if a product setting calls her a teen user.

5

The Data Fiduciary decides the purpose and the means of processing, alone or with others. The Data Processor processes on the fiduciary's behalf. Picture a hospital that chooses to collect insurance details and a billing vendor that only posts invoices on the hospital's instructions. The hospital is the fiduciary. The vendor is the processor. If the vendor starts its own marketing list from those invoices, it has stepped outside a pure processor role for that new purpose. Role labels follow decisions, not the job title printed on a contract.

6

Consent Manager is the definition people most often misuse. Under section 2 it is a person registered with the Board, acting as a single point of contact so a Data Principal can give, manage, review, and withdraw consent through an accessible, transparent, and interoperable platform. Registration is section 6(9), which commences on 13 November 2026. On 2 October 2026 it is not in force. A company's own consent banner, and a product that helps the company run that banner, are not automatically Consent Managers. Do not print the statutory title on an unregistered tool.

7

A personal data breach, as section 2 defines it, is wider than a hacker story. It includes unauthorised processing, and it includes accidental disclosure, acquisition, sharing, use, alteration, destruction, or loss of access, where confidentiality, integrity, or availability is compromised. An employee emailing a customer list to the wrong vendor can fall inside that definition. Saying the word correctly is allowed now. Telling the Board and each affected Data Principal is a duty in the fiduciary-obligation provisions, and those commence on 13 May 2027. The Act does not add a 72-hour deadline.

8

Two purpose words need a clean landing. The specified purpose is the purpose in the notice given to the Data Principal. A lawful purpose, under section 4, is a purpose not expressly forbidden by law. Neither phrase means a general business interest borrowed from another country's statute. If your old deck says 'legitimate interest' as a DPDP ground, retire that heading. Section 4 and section 7 use the Act's own grounds, and they commence on 13 May 2027. This module defined the words. It did not give you legal advice on a live form.

Module 04

Applicability and Territorial Scope

About 11 minutes

1

Scope is the question of whether this Act is even the right statute for a given activity. Section 3 answers it. Notification G.S.R. 843(E) appoints section 3 for 13 May 2027. On 2 October 2026 the section is enacted and is not being enforced. That timing matters when a sales team wants a slide that says 'DPDP already applies to every screen we ship.' Teach the test. Date the test. A domestic example is a Pune retailer scanning paper loyalty cards into an app. Digitisation is part of the story section 3 tells.

2

Inside the territory of India, the Act applies to processing of digital personal data collected in digital form, or collected on paper and digitised later. A hospital that types a paper admission form into its system is on the second path. A diary that stays in a drawer, never copied into a computer, is not digital personal data. Teams sometimes fear that every sticky note is regulated by this Act. Read section 3 with the section 2 definition. The Act's application is aimed at digital personal data, including data that becomes digital.

3

The overseas sentence is narrower than many people expect. Processing outside India is covered if it is in connection with any activity of offering goods or services to Data Principals within India. Picture a clothing site hosted abroad that prices goods for delivery in India and opens accounts for customers here. That offering is the connection section 3 describes. The section does not add a free-standing monitoring test from another law. Do not paste a foreign extra-territorial clause into the training and call it section 3.

4

Two exclusions keep the Act from swallowing ordinary private life. First, personal data processed by an individual for a personal or domestic purpose is outside section 3. A person keeping a household festival guest list on a phone is the sort of example the exclusion is built for. A company processing its users is not an individual at home. If a startup calls its entire customer database 'domestic' because the founder works from a kitchen table, the exclusion is being stretched past its words.

5

The second exclusion covers personal data that the Data Principal herself makes publicly available, or that someone else makes publicly available because the law obliges them to. If a professional posts her own office phone number on a profile she chose to publish, start with that exclusion when you discuss that published item. Do not jump from one public post to a claim that all scraped data, from every source, is outside the Act. And do not treat the exclusion as already enforced analysis on 2 October 2026. Section 3 commences on 13 May 2027.

6

Combine the tests in the order a product review can survive. Ask whether you have digital personal data. Ask whether processing is in India, or outside India in connection with offering goods or services to Data Principals in India. Then ask whether a real exclusion fits, using the section's words rather than a slogan. A payments app offered to users in India, with accounts stored anywhere, should walk that list. Write the conclusion as preparation. The lawful-purpose and consent rules that tell you how to process, in sections 4 to 7, are on the same 13 May 2027 date.

7

A frequent error is to announce that the Act has no overseas reach, or that it reaches every website on earth. Neither sentence is section 3. There is overseas reach, and it is tied to offering goods or services to Data Principals in India. There is also a boundary. Training should hold both. Another error is to discuss applicability as if enforcement had already begun on the review date. Definitions in section 2 are in force. Section 3 is not yet in force. Say both sentences to the same audience.

8

Close with a practical label. A team may map its products against section 3 now, and it should mark the map 'preparation for 13 May 2027,' not 'live obligation on 2 October 2026.' For example, an Indian subsidiary and a foreign parent can each be asked the offering question, instead of assuming the parent's foreign privacy policy answers Indian scope. This module is education. It does not decide a borderline cross-border product for you. That decision needs the text of section 3 and, where the facts are awkward, qualified advice.

Module 05**Personal Data and Digital Personal Data**

About 10 minutes

1

People argue about privacy in the abstract and then freeze when they see a spreadsheet. This module is about recognition. Section 2 asks whether the data is about an individual who is identifiable by or in relation to it. A courier label with a person's name and phone number is an easy yes. A door code that is shared by a whole building, with no link to one resident, may be a different answer. Train teams to ask the identifiability question. The definition has been in force since 13 November 2025.

2

Digital form is the second question, and it is practical. Personal data written only in a paper visitor book is not digital personal data while it stays on paper. The moment a guard types the same name into an entry app, the record is digital. Section 3, commencing on 13 May 2027, expressly covers personal data collected in non-digital form and digitised subsequently. A factory that scans old gate registers 'just for archive' has created digital personal data. Say that plainly in the scan project, not after the archive is full.

3

Identifiability is not limited to a column headed 'name'. A rare combination can point to one person. Think of a small branch where the export says only 'branch manager, satellite office, hired March'. Colleagues can tell who that is. Section 2's phrase 'by or in relation to such data' is there for that reason. A product manager should not clear a file merely because a name field was dropped. If support staff can re-identify the row from the rest, you still have personal data.

4

The same file can mix business records and personal data. An invoice for a sole proprietor may show a trade name and also the owner's mobile number. The trade context does not delete the personal data. It also does not select a legal ground. When sections 4, 6, and 7 commence on 13 May 2027, processing still needs a lawful purpose and either consent or a certain legitimate use listed in the Act. A GDPR-style legitimate interest is not a DPDP ground. Do not let the word invoice do that legal work.

5

Sound, image, and location are data too. A gated-community camera that records residents' faces, stored on a digital recorder, is not 'just security equipment' for classification purposes. If the face identifies a person, you are looking at digital personal data. Whether a later security use fits a ground in the Act is a separate question for the provisions that commence on 13 May 2027. Classification comes first. Teams that skip it cannot write an honest notice later, because they do not know what they hold.

6

The breach definition helps you talk about harm without waiting for a hacker headline. Section 2 covers unauthorised processing and accidental disclosure, sharing, alteration, destruction, or loss of access, where confidentiality, integrity, or availability is compromised. A finance officer who overwrites the only copy of employee bank details has an availability and integrity problem, not a minor tidy-up. You may use that definition now. You may not tell staff that a statutory intimation is already due on 2 October 2026. That duty commences on 13 May 2027, in the form and manner prescribed, with no 72-hour rule written into the Act.

7

Build a short classification habit as a recommendation, and label it as one. For each new field, note whether it identifies a person, whether it is digital, and which system stores it. A school adding a parent WhatsApp number to a fee app can finish that note in minutes. The note does not make section 5 or section 6 enforceable early. It stops the school from discovering the field only when a parent asks a question after 13 May 2027. Good inventories are preparation. They are not a substitute for the commencement notification.

8

Leave this module able to correct two slogans. 'If there is no name, it is not personal data' is too narrow for section 2. 'Everything in the company is already regulated today' is too wide for G.S.R. 843(E), because the operational duties commence on 13 May 2027. Hold the middle. Classify digital personal data accurately now, using a definition that is in force, and schedule the notice, consent, and security duties against their real date. This is training for that judgment. It is not legal advice on a disputed dataset.

Module 06

Data Principal

About 11 minutes

1

If you remember one person from this course, remember the Data Principal. She is the individual the personal data is about. When a bank stores your photograph for a record, you are the Data Principal. The photographer, the branch manager, and the software vendor are not, unless the file is also about them. Section 2 gives this definition, and it has been in force since 13 November 2025. On 2 October 2026 a team can already label the right human being. That label is the start of every later right and duty.

2

Children change who stands in the definition. Section 2 says that where the Data Principal is a child, the term includes the parents or lawful guardian. A child is an individual who has not completed eighteen years of age. A learning app that treats a fifteen-year-old as if she had the same legal footing as a forty-year-old is ignoring section 2. The heavier processing rules in section 9, including verifiable parental consent, commence on 13 May 2027. You can still stop writing copy that pretends a child is just another email address.

3

A person with disability is also expressly covered. Section 2 includes her lawful guardian, acting on her behalf, within the term Data Principal. A service designer should not assume every account holder can act alone. The practical recommendation is to leave room for a guardian relationship and to confirm the prescribed method before 13 May 2027, rather than inventing an identity document the Act has not specified in the definition. The definition tells you who is included. It does not, by itself, publish a form.

4

Rights come in a set, and the set is not yet in force. Sections 11 to 14 give the Data Principal access to information, correction and erasure, grievance redressal, and a right to nominate someone for death or incapacity. Notification G.S.R. 843(E) appoints those sections for 13 May 2027. A polite support inbox on 2 October 2026 may be good service. It is not proof that section 11 is being enforced. When you build the inbox, label it as preparation for the commencement date.

5

Duties run toward the Data Principal as well as toward the organisation. Section 15 includes duties to follow applicable law while exercising rights, not to impersonate another person, not to suppress material information for specified State identity documents, not to register a false or frivolous grievance, and to give verifiably authentic information when asking for correction or erasure. The Schedule maximum for breach of Data Principal duties is Rs 10,000. It is a maximum, not an automatic fine, and the penalty provisions commence on 13 May 2027.

6

Do not turn the duty section into a script for blaming customers early. On the review date, section 15 is not being enforced. A shop that tells a customer she already owes a statutory penalty for a complaint is misusing the Schedule. What the shop can say is that, when section 15 commences, false or frivolous grievances are a statutory duty issue, and the Board's penalty is capped. Tone matters. The Data Principal is the person the law protects and also the person who has duties. Training should carry both without a threat.

7

Watch shared and family accounts. A household tablet login may mix a parent's data and a child's data. Section 2 still asks whose data it is, and it includes the parent or lawful guardian when the individual is a child. A streaming service that collects a child's viewing history under a parent's email should not file the whole record as 'adult, because the payer is an adult.' Sort the data by the individual it identifies. The children's obligations that restrict tracking and targeted advertising commence later, on 13 May 2027, under section 9.

8

End by telling the truth about timing in one customer-facing sentence. For example: 'You are the Data Principal for this account. The access and correction rights in the DPDP Act commence on 13 May 2027. Until then we can still help you as a service matter.' That sentence respects section 2 and G.S.R. 843(E). It does not pretend the rights chapter is already live, and it does not refuse ordinary help. This module is education. It does not authorise a script for a live complaint without checking the text and taking advice where needed.

Module 07

Data Fiduciary

About 12 minutes

1

Titles on email signatures do not decide this module. A Data Fiduciary is any person who, alone or jointly, determines the purpose and means of processing personal data. Ask two questions. Why is this data being processed? Who chose that why, and the way it will be done? A pharmacy chain that decides to keep prescription pickup records for its own reminder service is answering both questions. Section 2 has supplied this definition since 13 November 2025. You can apply it on the 2 October 2026 review date.

2

Joint projects need a calm split. An airline and a hotel may both receive a traveller's name in one booking, and each may determine its own purpose. Each can be a Data Fiduciary for the processing it decides. The test is not 'whose logo is on the app.' If they truly decide a shared purpose and the means together, section 2's phrase 'alone or in conjunction with other persons' is the one to read. Write the split down in the project note. A vague 'we are partners' line will not help when a traveller asks who is responsible.

3

Do not confuse the fiduciary with the processor who carries out instructions. A payroll company that calculates salaries only as the employer directs is a processor for that job. The employer who decided to collect bank details for wages is the fiduciary. If the payroll company starts mining those details to sell loans, it has determined a new purpose. Role can change with the decision. Contract labels help only when they match the facts. This distinction is definitional now. The section 8 duty to bind a processor by a valid contract commences on 13 May 2027.

4

Accountability is the reason the label matters, and it is timed. When section 8 commences on 13 May 2027, the Data Fiduciary is responsible for complying with the Act, including for processing it does through a processor. It must also take reasonable security safeguards and, if there is a personal data breach, give intimation in the form and manner prescribed. On 2 October 2026 you may call the right party the fiduciary. You may not say those section 8 duties are already being enforced. The Act also does not turn the intimation into a 72-hour GDPR rule.

5

Size is not a statutory switch. Section 10 lets the Central Government notify a Significant Data Fiduciary based on factors such as the volume and sensitivity of personal data, risk to the rights of the Data Principal, and potential impact on sovereignty and integrity, electoral democracy, security of the State, and public order. A large retailer is not an SDF because a manager feels large. There must be a notification. Section 10 itself commences on 13 May 2027. Until both the date and a notification arrive, do not print SDF duties as if they already bind you.

6

A consent screen does not change who the fiduciary is. The organisation that decides to collect the email for an account is still the Data Fiduciary. A Consent Manager, by contrast, is a person registered with the Board to let the Data Principal give, manage, review, and withdraw consent. That registration, in section 6(9), commences on 13 November 2026. A product such as Consent Guru can help a fiduciary present choices. It does not become the fiduciary, and it is not a registered Consent Manager. Keep the three roles on three lines of the diagram.

7

If your team learned the word controller elsewhere, use it only as a bridge and then drop it. The DPDP term is Data Fiduciary. The bridge becomes dangerous when someone imports a foreign ground called legitimate interest and treats it as section 7. The Act's grounds, when they commence on 13 May 2027, are consent under section 6 or certain legitimate uses under section 7, for a lawful purpose under section 4. A workshop example: a newsletter signup is a consent design problem, not a legitimate-interest checkbox copied from a European template.

8

Close with a sentence a chief executive can repeat. We are a Data Fiduciary where we decide why and how personal data is processed. Our operational duties under section 8 commence on 13 May 2027. We are not a Significant Data Fiduciary unless the Central Government notifies us under section 10. For example, the executive can use that sentence in a board pack instead of a slide that says the company is already an SDF facing live penalties. This module is education. A disputed joint-controller style contract still needs the facts and qualified advice.

Module 08

Data Processor

About 10 minutes

1

A Data Processor is the person who processes personal data on behalf of a Data Fiduciary. The work may be hosting, printing, payroll calculation, or sending email. The legal idea is the same. The processor carries out processing for the fiduciary's purpose, under the fiduciary's decision. Section 2 has defined the role since 13 November 2025. A city council that hires a firm only to digitise existing forms can call that firm a processor for the scanning job, provided the firm does not decide a new use for the scans.

2

The contract comes in with section 8, not with the definition. When section 8 commences on 13 May 2027, the Data Fiduciary may engage a processor under a valid contract. On 2 October 2026 that statutory contract rule is not yet being enforced. You can still negotiate the contract as a recommendation. A useful draft says what the vendor may do, what it must not do, how it protects the data, and when it must delete it. Do not describe those commercial clauses as if they were already a commenced penalty event.

3

Responsibility does not travel away with the server. Section 8, from 13 May 2027, makes the Data Fiduciary responsible for complying with the Act for processing done on its behalf. A retailer cannot point at a cloud contract and say the cloud company is the only party who must answer for the retailer's customer database. The cloud company has its own promises. The statute keeps the fiduciary in the frame. Training should say this before a procurement team treats outsourcing as an exit from the Act.

4

Erasure is where sloppy vendor terms surface. When the fiduciary has to erase, section 8 requires it to cause the processor to erase as well, unless the law requires retention. That duty commences on 13 May 2027. Picture a gym that stops a membership and asks its billing vendor to delete the member's phone number. If the vendor's terms say it may keep the number indefinitely for the vendor's own marketing, the gym does not have a clean processor story. Fix the term in preparation. Do not invent a 72-hour deletion clock the Act does not state.

5

Watch the moment a vendor wants the data for itself. A support-desk tool may host tickets for a client and also ask to reuse ticket text to improve the tool's general model. The hosting, on the client's instructions, can be processor activity. The model reuse is the vendor determining a purpose. Call the second flow what it is. If it needs a ground once sections 6 and 7 commence, that ground is consent or a certain legitimate use, not a GDPR legitimate-interest sentence pasted into an order form.

6

One vendor can wear two hats, and the diagram should show both. An email platform might send only the messages a shop requests, and separately run its own advertising network using shopper addresses. For the requested messages it can be a processor. For the advertising network it is determining purpose and is a Data Fiduciary for that processing. A single master service agreement that blurs the hats will confuse staff. Split the description by purpose. The underlying section 8 obligations still wait until 13 May 2027 before they are in force.

7

Do not promote a processor into a Consent Manager because it stores consent logs. A Consent Manager is a person registered with the Board, and section 6(9) registration commences on 13 November 2026. A log archive is not that registration. Consent Guru, used by an organisation to record its own customers' choices, is a product role, not a Board registration. On 2 October 2026 nobody should tell a client that the processor has already been registered as a Consent Manager under a provision that has not commenced.

8

Leave procurement with three checks. Who decides the purpose? Is the vendor only processing on behalf of that decision? What happens to the data when the purpose ends? A university hiring an SMS gateway for admission alerts can answer those in a page. Mark the page as preparation for section 8 on 13 May 2027, because the contract duty is not being enforced on the review date. This module is education. It does not review a specific vendor contract for you, and it is not legal advice on whether a clause is valid.

Module 09**Consent under the DPDP Act**

About 13 minutes

1

Consent is a decision, not a banner colour. Section 6 says it must be free, specific, informed, unconditional, and unambiguous, and it must come through a clear affirmative action. It has to show agreement to processing for the specified purpose, and only for the personal data that purpose needs. A banking app that asks for location 'to find branches,' with a separate yes, is in the right neighbourhood. An app that buries five unrelated uses behind one dim continue button is not. These standards commence on 13 May 2027. They are not being enforced on 2 October 2026.

2

Free and unconditional are everyday words with a statutory job. If a person must agree to sale of her profile to unknown advertisers in order to read a manual that does not need that sale, the extra agreement is not necessary for the specified purpose. Section 6 limits consent to necessary data. It also expects the request to be presented clearly, including where it sits inside a contract, and in plain language, with a choice of English or an Eighth Schedule language. A telecom form that pre-ticks marketing is a teaching example of what a clear affirmative action is not.

3

Informed means the person can tell what she is agreeing to. That links consent to the notice in section 5, which you will study next. The request should identify the personal data and the purpose, and it should show how to reach a person who can answer. A clinic that says 'we will use your number to send the lab report' is informing her about a specified purpose. A clinic that says 'we may use data for business purposes' is not naming a purpose she can understand. Both the notice section and these consent standards commence on 13 May 2027. Draft them now as preparation.

4

Withdrawal is part of consent, not a favour. The Data Principal may withdraw it at any time, and the ease of withdrawal must be comparable to the ease of giving consent. If she consented with one tap, do not send her through a call centre that is open one hour a week. Withdrawal does not make earlier processing unlawful if that processing rested on valid consent. After withdrawal, the fiduciary must within a reasonable time cease processing and cause its processors to cease, unless the Act or another law still requires or authorises the processing. She bears the consequences of withdrawal, which you should explain in plain words, not as a threat.

5

Proof sits with the organisation. If there is a question whether a notice was given or consent was given as the Act requires, section 6 puts the obligation to prove it on the Data Fiduciary. A retailer that cannot show what the customer saw, or whether she took an affirmative action, will be in a weak place once the section is in force. Keeping a record is the practical recommendation that follows from that burden. On 2 October 2026 the burden itself has not commenced. Build the record anyway, and do not describe a missing archive as an already enforceable breach.

6

The Consent Manager path is real and it is dated. Section 6 lets a Data Principal give, manage, review, and withdraw consent through a Consent Manager, who is accountable to her. Every Consent Manager must be registered with the Board. That registration rule is section 6(9), commencing on 13 November 2026, with section 27(1)(d) and Rule 4. It is not in force on 2 October 2026. A company's own consent tool, including a product such as Consent Guru, can store the

company's own choices. It is not, by that fact, a registered Consent Manager.

7

Do not use consent as a costume for a different ground, and do not skip it by borrowing one. Certain legitimate uses under section 7 are a closed statutory list, such as a voluntary provision for a specified purpose where she has not objected, particular State functions, emergencies, and defined employment uses. They are not a general legitimate-interest test. A jewellery brand that wants an optional festival promotion should design consent, not paste a foreign legitimate-interest paragraph. Section 7 and the consent standards share the 13 May 2027 commencement date. Learn both before you pick a screen.

8

Put the timing in the release notes of any consent redesign. For example: 'This screen aims at section 6. Those standards commence on 13 May 2027. Registration of a Consent Manager is a separate matter and commences on 13 November 2026. This release is preparation, not a claim that enforcement has begun.' That note stops a marketing claim that the brand is already certified. This module is education. It does not clear a particular form of words as legally sufficient. Check the Act and, when the rules commence, the prescribed manner, and take advice for a live campaign.

Module 10

Notice and Transparency Requirements

About 12 minutes

1

A notice is the explanation that sits with a consent request. Section 5 says the request must be accompanied or preceded by a notice from the Data Fiduciary. The notice has to tell the Data Principal the personal data and the purpose, how she may exercise her rights, and how she may complain to the Board. The purpose you name becomes the specified purpose. A food app that says it uses a phone number to share a delivery PIN is giving a purpose a person can picture. Section 5 commences on 13 May 2027. On 2 October 2026 it is not being enforced.

2

Plain language is part of respect, and the Act also sets a language option. The Data Principal must be able to access the contents in English or in any language listed in the Eighth Schedule. A bank that serves customers in more than one language should plan for that choice, instead of offering a scan of a dense English contract only. The detailed manner is prescribed. Rule 3, which is part of the operational set, commences on 13 May 2027 with section 5. Until then, do not label an internal template as the official prescribed form. You may still write a clear draft as a recommendation.

3

Specific purpose is where notices usually fail. 'To improve services' can mean anything, so it specifies little. 'To refund this failed payment to the card you used' tells the person what will happen. If the same refund file will also feed a lookalike advertising audience, that second use is a different purpose and has to be stated on its own. Consent for it, when section 6 is in force, must be specific and limited to the data that purpose needs. Do not hide the second use in a footnote the screen never shows. The pair of sections, 5 and 6, commence together on 13 May 2027.

4

Rights and complaints belong in the notice, not only in a policy nobody links. Section 5 requires the notice to explain the manner of exercising rights and the manner of making a complaint to the Board. Those rights, in sections 11 to 14, commence on the same date as the notice. A coherent draft says, in short sentences, that the person will be able to seek access, correction, erasure, and grievance redressal, and how a complaint to the Board can be made once that path is available. On the review date, do not write 'you can sue us at the Board tomorrow' as if the enforcement machinery for fiduciary duties were already open.

5

There is a transitional rule for consent that already exists. Where a Data Principal gave consent before commencement, section 5 requires the fiduciary, as soon as reasonably practicable, to give her a notice containing the information the section lists. A streaming service with a large legacy mailing list should plan that communication. The statute's timing phrase is 'as soon as reasonably practicable.' Do not replace it with a 72-hour figure borrowed from another law's breach rule. And do not run the communication on 2 October 2026 while telling people the duty is already in force. Section 5 commences on 13 May 2027.

6

Contact details support the notice. Section 8 requires a Data Fiduciary to publish the business contact information of a Data Protection Officer, if applicable, or of a person who can answer questions about the processing. A Data Protection Officer in the full statutory sense is an additional obligation of a Significant Data Fiduciary under section 10, after a government notification, not a

badge every shop must wear. Any fiduciary will still need a real person who can answer. Both section 8 and section 10 commence on 13 May 2027. Publishing a monitored inbox now is a recommendation, not a claim of early enforcement.

7

A tool can present the notice. It cannot change the law. Consent Guru may help an organisation show an itemised explanation and store what the user saw. That is the organisation acting as a Data Fiduciary, or preparing to. It does not make Consent Guru a Consent Manager registered with the Board. Registration under section 6(9) commences on 13 November 2026 and is not open on the review date. When you demo a banner, say what is statutory - data, purpose, rights, complaint path - and what is layout. Layout is a design choice unless and until a commenced rule prescribes it.

8

Finish with a review question your writer can apply. Can a customer tell what data you want, why you want it, how she will exercise her rights, and how she can complain to the Board? If the answer is no, the draft is not yet a section 5 notice. For example, rewrite 'we value your privacy' into 'we use your address to deliver this order.' Then date the page: section 5 commences on 13 May 2027, and this draft is preparation. The course is not legal advice, and a live campaign still needs a check against the Act and, after commencement, the prescribed manner.

Module 11

Lawful Purpose, Specified Purpose, and Certain Legitimate Uses

About 13 minutes

1

Before a team argues about a button, it should ask whether the processing is allowed at all. Section 4 says a person may process personal data only in accordance with the Act and for a lawful purpose. Lawful purpose means a purpose not expressly forbidden by law. There are two routes: the Data Principal has given consent, or the use is one of the certain legitimate uses. A courier collecting an address for a delivery the customer requested is the kind of scene this module starts from. Section 4 commences on 13 May 2027. It is not being enforced on 2 October 2026.

2

Keep specified purpose and lawful purpose in different hands. The specified purpose is the purpose written in the notice. Lawful purpose is the section 4 idea that the aim is not forbidden. A clinic may have a lawful aim in sending a lab result, and the notice should specify that aim. A purpose that a criminal law forbids does not become lawful because a patient clicked yes. Training slides that treat the two phrases as synonyms will mis-draft notices. Both section 4 and the notice rule in section 5 commence on 13 May 2027, so the drafting you do now is preparation.

3

Section 7 is where people import the wrong foreign heading. The Act says certain legitimate uses. It does not say legitimate interest, and it does not invite a free-form balance of business needs against privacy. The first listed use is narrow: the specified purpose for which she voluntarily provided her personal data, where she has not indicated that she does not consent. Picture a hotel guest who gives a mobile number so the desk can share the room number. That provision is about the purpose she volunteered the data for. It is not a reason to enrol her in a third-party travel marketplace she never heard of.

4

Read the State and emergency uses as a list you do not expand. The section covers the State issuing a subsidy, benefit, service, certificate, licence, or permit in the circumstances it describes, including where data is already in a notified State database. It covers State functions under law and the interests of sovereignty, integrity, and security of the State. It covers a legal duty to disclose information to the State, compliance with a judgment or order, a medical emergency, treatment and health services in an epidemic or other public-health threat, and help during a disaster or a breakdown of public order. A private shop's Diwali sale is not on that list.

5

Employment deserves its own careful paragraph because it is easy to overuse. Section 7 allows processing for employment purposes, or to safeguard the employer from loss or liability. The Act's examples include preventing corporate espionage, protecting trade secrets, intellectual property and classified information, and providing a service or benefit the employee asked for. Payroll so you can pay the wage she expects sits naturally in that employment idea. A plan to sell employee phone numbers to a retailer does not. If you cannot point to the employment use in ordinary language, design consent instead of stretching the list.

6

Choosing a ground is an operational habit you can start before the section is in force, if you label it

honestly. On a one-page brief, write the purpose, say whether it is forbidden by any law you already know, and pick consent or name the section 7 use. A university alumni office that wants optional donation emails should plan a consent request, not a legitimate-interest memo. The brief should say sections 4, 6, and 7 commence on 13 May 2027. On the review date, do not tell fundraisers that a missing consent is already a commenced penalty. Penalty provisions are in that same later tranche.

7

Two mistakes show up in inherited templates. The first is a checkbox labelled legitimate interest, copied from a European pack, used for Indian customer data. Delete it. The second is treating voluntary provision as deemed permission for every future campaign. Voluntary provision tracks the specified purpose she provided the data for, and it falls away if she indicates she does not consent. A bookstore that received an address for a single posted order should not assume a lifetime of partner mailings. Correct the template now. Call the correction preparation, not a claim that section 7 is already live.

8

Close by giving a manager a sentence she can say in a product review. We process only for a lawful purpose. We use consent, or a certain legitimate use actually listed in section 7. We do not use a general legitimate-interest ground, because the Act does not give us one. For example, the optional app-personalisation feature will be a separate consent, while delivering the booked ticket can be examined under voluntary provision. Those sections commence on 13 May 2027. This module is education, not a legal opinion on a borderline employment-monitoring tool.

Module 12**Processing of Children's Data**

About 14 minutes

1

Start with the age, because product teams often import a different number from another law. Section 2 says a child is an individual who has not completed eighteen years of age. A seventeen-year-old on a learning site is a child for this Act. The definition has been in force since 13 November 2025, so you can classify accounts correctly on 2 October 2026. What you cannot say is that the processing bans are already being enforced. Those live in section 9, which Notification G.S.R. 843(E) appoints for 13 May 2027. Classification now, obligations later: say both.

2

Verifiable consent is the first section 9 duty. Before processing personal data of a child, or of a person with disability who has a lawful guardian, the Data Fiduciary must obtain the verifiable consent of the parent or lawful guardian. A cartoon app that asks the child to tap 'I agree' and never involves a parent is not that design. How verification works is prescribed, and those operational rules commence on 13 May 2027. Do not freeze a particular ID document into the policy and call it already mandatory. Do design a parent path as a recommendation, and check the commenced rules before the date.

3

The Act is not only about the consent form. Section 9 prohibits processing that is likely to cause any detrimental effect on the well-being of a child. A feature that pressures a child into spending, or that exposes her to harm the fiduciary can already foresee, belongs in that sentence when you do the review. The standard is the Act's, not a vague brand value. Because the section commences on 13 May 2027, a harmful feature is a reason to redesign now, and it is not yet a commenced penalty on the review date. The Schedule maximum later is up to Rs 200 crore, and it is a maximum, not an automatic fine.

4

Tracking, behavioural monitoring, and targeted advertising directed at children are specifically restricted. Picture a video site that watches which cartoons a ten-year-old replays and then sells that pattern to a snack brand for ads aimed at her. That is the conduct section 9 names. Do not hide it behind the phrase 'relevant content.' If the Central Government later exempts a class of fiduciary or a purpose, the exemption will be in a notification or prescription, and only where the government is satisfied the processing is verifiably safe. A team does not write its own exemption because the product is popular.

5

Persons with disability who have a lawful guardian are in the verifiable-consent sentence with children. Section 2 already includes the lawful guardian, acting on her behalf, in the term Data Principal. Section 9 then requires verifiable consent of that guardian before processing. A benefits portal should not assume every adult user can consent alone when a lawful guardian is in place. The prescribed way of verifying the guardian should be taken from the rules when they commence on 13 May 2027, not invented in a slide. Until then, leave a guardian route in the journey as preparation.

6

Penalties need calm numbers. The Schedule maximum for the children's provisions is up to Rs 200 crore. The Board imposes a penalty after inquiry, up to the maximum. It is not a flat fine that lands on

every mistake. Those penalty provisions commence on 13 May 2027. On 2 October 2026 a founder should not be told she is already exposed to that sum as a live enforcement fact. She should be told the number is an enacted maximum, the date it commences, and that building an age gate is preparation. Fear without the date produces bad policy. The date without the redesign produces a late surprise.

7

Map where children actually appear. A family streaming plan, a school fee app, a game with in-app purchases, and a hospital's paediatric file are different facts, and each can involve a child under eighteen. The hospital's treatment questions may also touch section 7's emergency and health uses, which you must not casually merge with section 9. Read the children's prohibitions on their own. A practical recommendation is an inventory column: might this record identify a child, and do we track or advertise to her? Fill it before 13 May 2027. Do not stamp it 'already enforced.'

8

End with language a product manager can put in a ticket. If the user has not completed eighteen years, stop the behavioural ad profile, plan verifiable parent or guardian consent, and do not ship tracking directed at that child. Note that section 9 and the Rs 200 crore maximum commence on 13 May 2027. For example, the ticket can cover a revision-app leaderboard that currently shares a child's name with advertisers. This module is education. It does not clear a particular age-check vendor as the prescribed method, and it is not legal advice on a live children's service.

Module 13**Rights of Data Principals**

About 12 minutes

1

Rights are the part of the Act a customer will eventually feel. Sections 11 to 14 give the Data Principal access to information, correction and erasure, grievance redressal, and nomination. Section 15 adds her duties. Notification G.S.R. 843(E) places these sections in the 13 May 2027 tranche. On 2 October 2026 you should learn the set and you should not tell a caller that the rights are already being enforced. A telecom shop can still choose to answer questions kindly. Kindness is service. It is not section 11.

2

Access, in outline, lets her obtain a summary of the personal data being processed and the processing activities, the identities of other Data Fiduciaries and Data Processors with whom data was shared, with a description of what was shared, and other information the rules prescribe. There is a proviso for sharing with a Data Fiduciary authorised by law, on a written request, for prevention, detection, investigation, or prosecution of offences or cyber incidents. Do not promise a dump of police correspondence the proviso withholds. The detailed module on access comes next. The commencement date does not change: 13 May 2027.

3

Correction, erasure, grievance, and nomination each have a job. Correction and updating fix data that is wrong, incomplete, or stale. Erasure is not absolute where retention is necessary for the specified purpose or for compliance with law. Grievance redressal must be available, and she must use the fiduciary's or Consent Manager's channel before approaching the Board. Nomination lets her name someone to exercise her rights if she dies or is incapacitated. A hospital that mixes these four into one 'delete everything today' button will mishandle both care records and the statute. Split the journeys.

4

Duties stop the rights from being a tool for fraud. Section 15 says she must follow applicable law, must not impersonate another person, must not suppress material information when personal data is given for specified State identity documents, must not register a false or frivolous grievance, and must furnish verifiably authentic information when seeking correction or erasure. The Schedule maximum is Rs 10,000. It is a ceiling, not an automatic bill, and the penalty provisions commence on 13 May 2027. Do not wave that figure at an ordinary customer on the review date.

5

Channels matter as much as rights. The Data Fiduciary has to provide the means. A Consent Manager can also be in the grievance picture once that role exists. Registration of Consent Managers commences on 13 November 2026, which is still ahead of 2 October 2026. Until then, do not send people to a 'registered Consent Manager' you cannot point to. An in-house form, even one built with a product such as Consent Guru, is the organisation's own channel. It is not Board registration, and it does not make the product the Data Protection Board.

6

Prescribed timelines are a trap for confident slides. Section 13 says the fiduciary or Consent Manager shall respond within such period as may be prescribed. The Act, in the sections you are learning, does not hand you a universal number of days to print on a poster. The operational rules commence on 13 May 2027. A recommendation is to pick an internal service target and label it

internal. For example, a retailer might aim to acknowledge a complaint in a few working days as customer care, while stating that the statutory period will be the one the commenced rules prescribe. Do not invent the statutory number.

7

Prepare the operating model before the date. Name an owner for access, an owner for correction, a path for grievances, and a way to record a nominee. A university with alumni and students can sketch this on one page and mark every box 'commences 13 May 2027.' That page will save panic later. It should not be emailed to students as a claim that the rights are already live, and it should not threaten the Rs 10,000 maximum. If a student asks for a correction of a phone number today, the university may do it as administration. Say that is what it is.

8

Close by listing the four rights and one caution in spoken language. You will be able to ask what we hold and whom we shared it with, ask us to correct or erase within the Act's limits, use our grievance channel first, and nominate a person for death or incapacity. Those rights commence on 13 May 2027. For example, a support macro can say exactly that, and can still offer to fix a typo now as a service. This course is not legal advice. A disputed request, especially one that bumps into another law that requires retention, needs the text and qualified advice.

Module 14**Right to Access Information**

About 11 minutes

1

Access is the right to be told what is going on with your data. Section 11 says the Data Principal may obtain from the Data Fiduciary a summary of the personal data being processed and the processing activities undertaken. She may also obtain the identities of other Data Fiduciaries and Data Processors with whom the data was shared, plus a description of the personal data shared, and any other prescribed information. A clothing site that can say 'we hold your size and address, we use them to fulfil orders, and we shared the address with this courier' is speaking the shape of the right. The section commences on 13 May 2027.

2

The summary is not a blank spreadsheet dumped without thought, and it is not a slogan. It is an account of the personal data and the processing. If a clinic uses a phone number for appointments and a lab vendor for results, both facts belong in a serious answer once the right is in force. Teams that have never listed their processors will freeze. The recommendation is to keep that list now, labelled preparation. On 2 October 2026 do not tell patients that section 11 is already being enforced. Definitions are in force. This right is not.

3

Naming recipients is the part vendors hope you will skip. Section 11 asks for identities of all other Data Fiduciaries and Data Processors with whom personal data has been shared, and a description of what was shared. If a school sends parent numbers to an SMS gateway and to a fee-payment company, those identities are in scope, unless a real exception applies. 'Various partners' is not an identity. Build the habit of writing the legal name of the recipient next to the field shared. The statutory duty to answer commences on 13 May 2027. The inventory can start earlier as a recommendation.

4

The proviso is specific, so quote its situation rather than its mood. The fiduciary is not required to share information about personal data given to another Data Fiduciary authorised by law to obtain it, where that sharing was pursuant to a written request for prevention, detection, or investigation of offences or cyber incidents, or for prosecution or punishment of offences. A written request from such an authority is the scene. A commercial loyalty partner is not. If your access template hides every recipient 'for security,' rewrite it. The proviso is not a general secrecy blanket.

5

Manner and timing are prescribed, which means you do not invent them. The request is made in the manner prescribed, and other information may be added by prescription. Rules in the operational set commence on 13 May 2027, with section 11. A poster that says 'we will reply in 72 hours because GDPR does' is the wrong statute and the wrong clock. The Act's access right does not set a 72-hour rule. If you want an internal service target, call it internal. For example, an insurer might acknowledge letters quickly as customer care while it waits to apply the prescribed period after commencement.

6

Other laws can still require you to keep or withhold something. Section 11 does not teach you to ignore a statute that restricts disclosure. It also does not let you refuse the whole right because one attachment is sensitive. Separate the share you must describe from the share the proviso covers,

and get advice where a banking secrecy or similar rule is actually in play. This course will not decide that clash. It will tell you not to bluff. On the review date the further point is simple: even a perfect answer is preparation until 13 May 2027.

7

Do not outsource the identity of the answer. The Data Fiduciary is the one section 11 addresses. A Consent Manager is not a substitute name for the shop, and registration of Consent Managers is not in force on 2 October 2026. Consent Guru might store the incoming request for the organisation. The organisation still has to know its own data and its own recipients. A processor who holds the database must help as a contractual matter you should have planned, and once section 8 is in force the fiduciary remains responsible. Section 8 shares the 13 May 2027 date.

8

Try a tabletop before the commencement date. Give a fictional customer a request: what do you hold, what do you do with it, and who else received it. See whether the team can answer without the proviso being misused. A hotel, for example, should be able to name the booking engine and the payment processor and describe the fields. Then write on the exercise 'section 11 commences 13 May 2027.' That sentence keeps a useful drill from becoming a false legal claim. This module is education, not a template you can file with the Board as advice.

Module 15**Correction and Erasure**

About 12 minutes

1

People say 'delete my data' when they sometimes mean 'fix my data.' Section 12 covers both families. The Data Principal may seek correction, completion, updating, and erasure. If a bank has her year of birth wrong, correction is the right. If the address line has no flat number, completion is the right. If she has moved, updating is the right. The fiduciary who receives a proper request must correct inaccurate or misleading data, complete what is incomplete, and update what has changed. Section 12 commences on 13 May 2027. A branch that fixes a typo today can call it good administration, not an already enforced section.

2

Erasure on request has a statutory shape. She asks in the manner prescribed. The fiduciary erases unless retention is necessary for the specified purpose or for compliance with any law in force. Picture a retailer. The purpose of holding a one-time festival contest entry may be over, so erasure is the default once the section is in force. The purpose of holding a tax invoice may continue because a tax law says so. The staff script should ask which record she means. A blanket 'we delete nothing' and a blanket 'we delete the invoices too' can both be wrong. Do not invent the prescribed manner before the rules commence.

3

Section 8 erases even when she has not sent a section 12 letter. Unless the law requires retention, the fiduciary must erase when she withdraws consent, or as soon as it is reasonable to assume the specified purpose is no longer being served, whichever is earlier. It must also make its processor erase. A gym that collected a phone number only for a six-week trial, and that has finished the trial and taken a withdrawal of any leftover promotional consent, should be planning deletion of that number. The duty commences on 13 May 2027. On the review date, build the switch. Do not claim the switch is already a penalty event.

4

The Act also deems a purpose no longer served if the Data Principal does not approach the fiduciary for that purpose, and to exercise her rights, for such time as may be prescribed. The important word is prescribed. This course will not invent three years or any other number. The rules that can prescribe it are in the tranche that commences on 13 May 2027. A privacy notice that prints a homemade statutory period is guessing. An internal housekeeping rule can exist if you label it internal. For example, a newsletter tool might suppress inactive promotional contacts as a product choice, while the legal deeming period waits for the commenced rule.

5

Withdrawal and erasure travel together and are still not identical. Section 6 says that after withdrawal the fiduciary must within a reasonable time cease processing and cause processors to cease, unless the Act or another law still requires or authorises the processing. Section 8 then speaks to erasure unless retention is necessary for compliance with law. A food app can stop recommendation emails and still keep the last paid order if a law requires that invoice. Explain the split to the customer in plain words. Do not cite a 72-hour GDPR clock for either step. The DPDP phrases are reasonable time, and as soon as it is reasonable to assume the purpose is no longer served.

6

Processors are where erasure fails in practice. If the fiduciary must erase, section 8 says it shall

cause the Data Processor to erase too. A photo-print vendor that keeps customer images for its own gallery is not honouring that design. The contract should say the vendor deletes when the shop instructs, except where the law requires the shop to retain and the vendor is holding that copy for the shop. Negotiate this before 13 May 2027 as preparation. On 2 October 2026 a missing clause is a commercial gap, not yet a commenced section 8 breach. Say that honestly in the procurement meeting.

7

Corrections have to reach the place the decision is made. Section 8 also expects completeness, accuracy, and consistency when personal data is used to make a decision that affects the Data Principal or is disclosed to another fiduciary. A lender that corrects income in the application screen and leaves the old figure in the decision engine has not really corrected the fact that matters. Once the sections are in force, the right and the accuracy obligation point the same way. Neither is in force on 2 October 2026. A dry run, where you correct a test record in every system, is a useful recommendation.

8

Give the service team three sentences. We will correct or update data that is wrong or stale. We will erase when you ask, unless we still need the data for the specified purpose or a law requires us to keep it. These section 8 and section 12 duties commence on 13 May 2027, so today we are preparing. For example, use those sentences when a subscriber wants a marketing topic removed but a regulated policy schedule kept. This module is education. It does not tell you which tax or sector law requires retention in your business. That answer needs the other statute and, where it is unclear, qualified advice.

Module 16**Grievance Redressal**

About 11 minutes

1

A right that nobody can reach is not much of a right. Section 13 gives the Data Principal readily available means of grievance redressal provided by a Data Fiduciary or a Consent Manager. Readily available is practical. She should be able to find the path from the place she deals with you, such as an account page or a notice, and the path should work. A shop whose only route is a poster in a closed office has missed the idea. The section commences on 13 May 2027. On 2 October 2026, building the path is preparation, not a claim that the duty is already being enforced.

2

Someone has to answer. Section 8, on the same commencement date, requires publication of contact information for a Data Protection Officer where applicable, or for a person who can answer the Data Principal. For a Significant Data Fiduciary, section 10 makes the Data Protection Officer the point of contact for the grievance mechanism, and that officer must be based in India. Most companies are not SDFs unless the Central Government notifies them, and section 10 is not in force until 13 May 2027. Any fiduciary can still name a real inbox now. Call that a recommendation until the sections commence.

3

The clock is prescribed, so do not draw one from memory. Section 13 says the response shall be within such period as may be prescribed. The operational rules commence on 13 May 2027. If a vendor slide says the DPDP Act gives 72 hours to answer a grievance, the slide is mixing this right with a GDPR breach figure the Act does not use here. You may set an internal aim, and you should label it internal. A bank might choose to acknowledge quickly because customers deserve it, while telling staff the statutory period will be whatever the commenced rules prescribe. That honesty prevents a false poster.

4

Exhaustion is the step people skip in anger. The Data Principal shall exhaust the opportunity of redressing her grievance with the Data Fiduciary or Consent Manager before approaching the Board. When section 13 is in force, your reply is not a courtesy on the way to an instant Board case. It is the statutory first stop. Explain that without sounding like you are blocking her. A fair script says: please use this channel, we must respond within the prescribed period, and the Board comes after that opportunity. Do not say the Board has been deciding these fiduciary grievances since November 2025. Establishment of the Board and this duty are different tranches.

5

The Board can exist as an institution before this duty is live. Sections 18 to 26 commenced on 13 November 2025. Section 13, and the Board's functions in section 27 other than Consent Manager registration, commence on 13 May 2027. Section 27(1)(d), the registration function, commences on 13 November 2026. On the review date, 2 October 2026, do not blend those facts into 'file a penalty with the Board tomorrow.' Appeals from the Board to the Telecom Disputes Settlement and Appellate Tribunal are section 29, also in the 13 May 2027 tranche. You do not need the appeal to explain a grievance email. You do need to avoid sending people to a forum as if the duty were already open.

6

Consent Managers have a place in section 13 only when they are actually in the relationship. The

grievance means may be provided by a Data Fiduciary or a Consent Manager. A Consent Manager is a person registered with the Board, and that registration commences on 13 November 2026. A banner called a consent manager in a sales deck is not the statutory person. If your organisation uses Consent Guru to collect a complaint into its own queue, say that the organisation is providing the channel. Do not say the product is registered, and do not tell the customer her only statutory route is a registration that has not commenced.

7

Keep genuine complaints and false ones apart. Section 15 says a Data Principal must not register a false or frivolous grievance or complaint, and the Schedule maximum for her duties is Rs 10,000, commencing with the penalty provisions on 13 May 2027. That is not a tool for threatening someone who is upset about a real mistake. A food-delivery customer who never received an order and writes sharply is not, by tone alone, filing a frivolous statutory grievance. Train agents to investigate first. On the review date, do not mention the Rs 10,000 figure as a live fine at all.

8

Put the channel in the same notice you are drafting for section 5, because that notice must explain how she may exercise her rights. A complete future notice names the grievance path and how a complaint to the Board may be made. For example, a streaming service can place 'Raise a privacy grievance' next to the subscription button and describe it as the means section 13 will require from 13 May 2027. Until that date, the link can still help customers, if the caption does not claim the Act is already enforcing it. This module is education, not a finding on a live complaint.

Module 17

Nomination Rights

About 10 minutes

1

Most privacy talk assumes the person can speak for herself. Section 14 plans for the day she cannot. The Data Principal may nominate any other individual who, if she dies or becomes incapacitated, shall exercise her rights under the Act. A member of a co-operative bank might name her spouse. The spouse would then be able to exercise rights such as access or correction, within the limits of those rights. The spouse does not become the bank. Section 14 commences on 13 May 2027. On 2 October 2026, offering a nomination field is preparation if you do not claim the right is already enforced.

2

Read the definition of incapacity aloud so staff do not improvise. The Act says incapacity means inability to exercise the rights of the Data Principal under the Act owing to unsoundness of mind or infirmity of body. A person who is on holiday is not incapacitated. A family quarrel about who is in charge is not, by itself, the definition. A person who cannot exercise her rights because of infirmity of body may be. The manner of establishing that, and the manner of nomination, are prescribed. Until the rules commence on 13 May 2027, do not invent a compulsory medical form and call it statutory.

3

The nominee exercises rights. He does not rewrite the Act. If section 12 would allow the fiduciary to retain a record because a law requires it, the nominee cannot demand deletion of that record either. If section 11's proviso would withhold a particular law-enforcement sharing, the nominee does not get a special copy. Train the team to ask 'what right is being exercised?' and then apply that section. A nominee who asks for a marketing erasure and a nominee who asks for a regulated claim file are not making the same request. Both conversations wait on section 14's commencement before they are statutory.

4

Do not mix nomination with guardianship. Where the Data Principal is a child, section 2 includes the parent or lawful guardian. Where she is a person with disability, it includes the lawful guardian acting on her behalf. Section 9 adds verifiable consent for those situations, from 13 May 2027. Section 14 is different: it is the Data Principal nominating someone for her own death or incapacity. A father of a twelve-year-old is in the child provisions, not automatically a section 14 nominee. A single dropdown labelled 'guardian or nominee or anyone' will confuse a call centre. Split the fields.

5

Other nomination laws are easy to confuse with this one. Insurance, banking, and provident-fund nominees often receive money. Section 14 is about exercising DPDP rights, not about inheriting a balance. The same person might be named in both places, and the legal effect is still different. A script that says 'our insurance nominee automatically receives all personal data under the DPDP Act' overclaims. When section 14 is in force, follow its words and the prescribed manner. When you are only looking at a payment nomination under another Act, say so. This course will not interpret that other Act for you.

6

Store the nomination with the same care as the data it concerns. The nominee's name and contact details are themselves personal data about the nominee. The fact that a person expects to act on death can be sensitive in a household. Limit staff access as a security recommendation under the

reasonable-safeguards idea you will meet in section 8, which also commences on 13 May 2027. Do not leave nomination letters in a shared inbox. For example, a hospital can keep the nomination on the patient's record with access limited to the records team, and can say the statutory right starts on 13 May 2027.

7

There is no penalty in the Schedule for simply not nominating. Section 15's duties are about lawful exercise of rights, impersonation, suppression of material information, false grievances, and authentic correction requests. The maximum for those duties is Rs 10,000, and it is not in force until 13 May 2027. Do not scare customers into nominating by inventing a fine. Offer the right, when it commences, as a right. A gentle service message is enough. A message that says 'nominate or pay a DPDP penalty' is wrong on the law and wrong on the date.

8

Finish with a plain offer a product owner can ship later. You may name an individual who can exercise your data-protection rights if you die or if you cannot exercise them because of unsoundness of mind or infirmity of body. We will follow the manner prescribed under section 14, which commences on 13 May 2027. For example, put that text behind a profile setting, not in a footer that claims the right is already live. This module is education. It is not legal advice on a disputed estate, and it does not decide who inherits property.

Module 18**Duties of Data Principals**

About 11 minutes

1

The Act does not only tell organisations what to do. Section 15 tells the Data Principal that her rights come with duties. She must comply with applicable law while exercising those rights. She must not impersonate another person when she provides personal data for a specified purpose. She must not suppress material information when she provides personal data for a State document, unique identifier, or proof of identity or address. She must not file a false or frivolous grievance with a fiduciary or the Board. And when she seeks correction or erasure, the information she furnishes must be verifiably authentic. Those duties commence on 13 May 2027.

2

Impersonation is the duty support teams already feel. A caller who knows a celebrity's name and demands the celebrity's booking history is not exercising a right. He is pretending to be someone else. Once section 15 is in force, that pretence is a statutory duty problem, not only a fraud policy. The same is true of a person who opens an account with a neighbour's identity. Your know-your-customer checks under other laws still matter. Section 15 does not replace them. It adds a DPDP duty with its own commencement date. On 2 October 2026 you may refuse the impersonator as a security practice. You may not say the DPDP penalty is already due.

3

State identity documents have their own bullet. The Data Principal must not suppress material information while providing personal data for a document, unique identifier, proof of identity, or proof of address issued by the State or its instrumentalities. If a form asks for a previous name that matters to the document, hiding it is the kind of conduct this duty addresses. It is not a duty to volunteer every secret to a shop. The context is those State issuances. Teach the limit so a retailer does not start a speech about section 15 when a customer declines a loyalty survey. That survey is a consent question, not this duty.

4

False or frivolous grievances can clog the channel genuine people need. Section 15 names that duty, and section 13 builds the channel. A fabricated story about a breach that never happened, filed to harass staff, is different from a real billing dispute told impatiently. Train the difference with examples from your own industry. An insurer can contrast a made-up policy number with a delayed claim that is angry and real. Only the first is a candidate for the frivolous label, and only once section 15 is in force. Even then, the company does not issue the statutory penalty. The Board does, up to the Schedule maximum.

5

The maximum is up to Rs 10,000. Say up to, every time. The Schedule does not say every breach costs exactly that sum, and it does not say the company may collect it at the counter. The penalty provisions commence on 13 May 2027. They are not in force on the review date. Compare it, so staff do not mix the rows: the children's maximum and the breach-notification maximum are up to Rs 200 crore, the security-safeguard maximum is up to Rs 250 crore, and the Data Principal duty maximum is up to Rs 10,000. Different rows, all maxima, all in the later penalty tranche.

6

Authentic information is the correction-and-erasure duty. If she asks you to change a date of birth, she must furnish information that is verifiably authentic. A typed chat message that says 'trust me,

change it to 1990' is not, by itself, that standard. When section 12 and section 15 are both in force, you can ask for authentic support for the correction and still complete a genuine update. You cannot demand the impossible and call it section 15, and you cannot refuse a clearly documented correction because you dislike requests. Both sections commence on 13 May 2027. Design the proof you will accept as a recommendation, and align it with the prescribed manner when the rules commence.

7

Do not let duties become a wall. A team that quotes section 15 in the first minute of every call will drive people away from a channel the Act wants to be readily available. Listen, fix what is actually wrong, and reserve the duty language for impersonation, suppressed material facts on State documents, false complaints, and inauthentic correction packages. A restaurant group, for example, should refund a real double payment without a lecture, and should refuse a stranger who wants the booking phone number changed to his own. Write those two endings on the same card so staff see the contrast.

8

Close with a sentence that cannot be misunderstood. Data Principals have duties under section 15, the Board may penalise a breach up to Rs 10,000 once the penalty provisions commence on 13 May 2027, and nobody at the company issues that penalty or quotes it as a live charge on 2 October 2026. For example, take the rupee figure off the hold music and the invoice footer. This module is education. It is not a finding that a particular caller has breached section 15, and it is not legal advice on a fraud case that other criminal law may also cover.

Module 19

Obligations of Data Fiduciaries

About 13 minutes

1

If you pin one operational section above a fiduciary's desk, pin section 8, and pin the date beside it. The Data Fiduciary must comply with the Act for processing it does itself and for processing a Data Processor does on its behalf. It may use a processor only under a valid contract. A hospital that outsources transcription has not stepped out of the Act. When section 8 commences on 13 May 2027, the hospital remains responsible. On 2 October 2026 that sentence is the law as enacted, not a duty already being enforced. You can still sign a better contract now and call it preparation.

2

Accuracy is not a call to perfect every stray field in the universe. Section 8 requires completeness, accuracy, and consistency when personal data is used to make a decision that affects the Data Principal, or when it is disclosed to another Data Fiduciary. A university that uses an exam score to decide a scholarship, or that sends that score to another institution, is in the sentence. A typo in an unused archive note is a different priority from a wrong score on the decision screen. Build a check where decisions and disclosures happen. The obligation commences on 13 May 2027. A dry run before that date is a recommendation.

3

Reasonable security safeguards are the heart of the section's protection duty, together with appropriate technical and organisational measures. Reasonable does not mean a particular brand of software named in the Act, and it does not mean a shrug. A payroll bureau that leaves salary files in an open shared drive is a teaching example of what will be hard to call reasonable once the section is in force. The Schedule maximum for failure to take reasonable security safeguards is up to Rs 250 crore. It is a maximum, imposed by the Board, and the penalty provisions commence on 13 May 2027. Do not tell the bureau the fine has already been assessed.

4

If a personal data breach happens, section 8 requires intimation to the Board and to each affected Data Principal, in the form and manner prescribed. Memorise 'form and manner prescribed' and forget the imported 72-hour slogan. The Act does not set that hour count. The rules that prescribe the form and manner are in the operational tranche commencing on 13 May 2027. A playbook can still say who to call internally, how to stop the bleeding, and where the contact list of affected people will come from. Label the statutory intimation as commencing later. The Schedule maximum for failure to notify a breach is up to Rs 200 crore, again a maximum, again not yet in force.

5

Erasure and purpose are obligations, not only customer-service gestures. Unless the law requires retention, erase when consent is withdrawn or as soon as it is reasonable to assume the specified purpose is no longer served, and make the processor erase too. The deeming period is as prescribed. A campaign agency that keeps a political-survey list forever 'just in case,' with no legal retention duty, is the example to challenge. Do not print a fake statutory retention number. Section 8 commences on 13 May 2027. Cleaning a list early can be a recommendation. Calling the clean-up a completed statutory duty on the review date would overclaim.

6

People need a human to write to. Section 8 requires publication of the business contact information of a Data Protection Officer, if applicable, or of a person who can answer questions about the

processing. 'If applicable' matters. The full Data Protection Officer appointment, based in India and answerable to the governing body, is a Significant Data Fiduciary obligation under section 10, and only after the Central Government notifies that status. A neighbourhood clinic is not an SDF by hope or by fear. It still needs a named person. Publish the name as preparation, and do not describe section 8 as already enforced on 2 October 2026.

7

Grievance redressal under section 13 has to be effective, and section 8 expects the fiduciary to have the mechanism. Put the contact and the path where the notice can point to them. A Consent Manager can also provide a grievance means, but only a registered one, and registration is not in force on the review date. Do not list Consent Guru, or your own banner, as that registered person. List your own officer or contact. For example, a marketplace can name its privacy desk in the seller agreement and in the customer notice, with a footnote that the statutory mechanism commences on 13 May 2027.

8

Give the leadership team a closing check that does not smuggle in foreign grounds. Are we the fiduciary? Is there a contract path for each processor? Where do we make decisions about people, and is that data accurate? What are our safeguards? Who do we tell, in the prescribed way, if a breach happens after 13 May 2027? What do we delete, and whom can a person contact? None of those questions is answered by a GDPR legitimate-interest paragraph. This module is education. It is not a security audit, and it is not legal advice that your current controls are reasonable.

Module 20**Security Safeguards and Personal Data Breaches**

About 12 minutes

1

Security talk often starts with tools and skips the definition. Section 2 says a personal data breach is unauthorised processing, or accidental disclosure, acquisition, sharing, use, alteration, destruction, or loss of access, that compromises confidentiality, integrity, or availability. A clinic laptop stolen from a car, with patient numbers on it, is easier to picture than a paragraph of threats. The definition has been in force since 13 November 2025. Use it to classify. The duty to have prevented the incident by reasonable safeguards, and the duty to intimate, sit in section 8 and commence on 13 May 2027.

2

Split the three words so an incident channel can use them. Confidentiality is about who can see the data. Integrity is about whether the data is still right. Availability is about whether it can be used. An outsider reading a salary file is a confidentiality problem. A staff member changing exam marks is an integrity problem. Ransomware that locks the only copy of medical histories is an availability problem, and it can be a loss of access under the definition. One incident can be more than one of these. Ask the question in the first hour of an internal review, as a recommendation, without pretending the statutory intimation duty is already live.

3

You do not need a hooded stranger. Accidental sharing is inside the definition. A teacher who sends a class list of phone numbers to the entire parent body, when it should have gone to one parent, may have compromised confidentiality. A developer who copies live customer data into an open test server may have done the same. Train people with these ordinary scenes so they report early. Reporting inside the company is a recommendation you can require in an employment policy today. Statutory intimation to the Board and to affected Data Principals, in the form and manner prescribed, commences on 13 May 2027. Do not mix the internal rule with the statutory one.

4

Reasonable security safeguards are the preventive duty in section 8. The Act pairs them with appropriate technical and organisational measures. It does not say 'buy this product and you are safe,' and it does not say a locked cupboard is enough for every digital system. Reasonable tracks the nature of the personal data and the way you process it. A neighbourhood salon and a hospital will not look identical, and both still have to be reasonable once the section is in force. Rules may prescribe safeguards. Those operational rules commence on 13 May 2027. Until then, do not label your internal standard as the prescribed code.

5

Recommendations should be honest about their status. Access control, so an intern cannot export the whole customer table, encryption of stored identity documents, a check on a vendor's admin accounts, and logs that show who downloaded a file, are sensible measures many organisations choose. They are examples of preparation, not a closed list enacted as section 8. A housing society that stores resident identity scans in a group chat is a clear example of a practice to stop, because the safeguard story is weak. Stopping it now is wise. Calling the stop a completed defence to a live Rs 250 crore penalty would be false on 2 October 2026.

6

Read the Schedule row carefully. Failure to take reasonable security safeguards to prevent a personal data breach carries a maximum of up to Rs 250 crore. Failure to notify the Board and

affected Data Principals is a different maximum, up to Rs 200 crore. The Board decides a penalty after inquiry. It is not automatic, and it is not a multiple you may invent. Both rows commence with the penalty provisions on 13 May 2027. A journalist who adds the two maxima together and calls the sum a fixed fine is not reading the Schedule. Correct that arithmetic in the board pack.

7

Connect safeguards to the rest of the fiduciary's life. A processor who holds the data is still your problem under section 8, because you remain responsible and you must cause erasure when erasure is due. A contract clause that asks the vendor to use reasonable safeguards and to tell you quickly about an incident is a recommendation aligned with the section you will have to meet. It does not commence the section early. An e-commerce firm, for example, can require its warehouse app vendor to restrict access to delivery phone numbers, and can note that the statutory duty starts on 13 May 2027. GDPR legitimate interest is not a safeguard and not a ground.

8

Leave the room with a classification habit and a date. If confidentiality, integrity, or availability of personal data is compromised by unauthorised or accidental conduct, call it a personal data breach in the section 2 sense and escalate inside the organisation. Do not promise a 72-hour filing, because the Act does not set one. Do not tell anyone the Rs 250 crore maximum is already in force. For example, put those three negatives on the incident card beside the phone number of the internal lead. The next module will cover intimation itself. This module is education, not a forensic report, and it is not legal advice on whether a past incident was reasonable.

Module 21**Data Breach Management and Notification**

About 14 minutes

1

When something goes wrong with personal data, people reach for a clock they learned elsewhere. Pause and open the Indian section. Section 8 says that on a personal data breach the Data Fiduciary shall intimate the Board and each affected Data Principal, in such form and manner as may be prescribed. That is the whole timing structure the Act itself gives you: form and manner prescribed. A courier company that emails the wrong route sheet to a stranger should use the section 2 definition to decide whether confidentiality is compromised, and should not invent an hour count. The intimation duty commences on 13 May 2027.

2

GDPR is a different law. Many teams remember that, under GDPR, a controller often has 72 hours to notify a supervisory authority. Do not paste that number into a DPDP standard operating procedure and call it section 8. If a commenced rule later speaks about time, you will follow that rule because it is prescribed, not because a European article felt familiar. On 2 October 2026 the prescribing operational rules for this duty have not commenced. They are in the 13 May 2027 tranche of the DPDP Rules, 2025. An internal rule such as 'call the privacy lead within the hour' can be a company control. Label it internal so nobody thinks it is the gazette.

3

Name the two recipients every time you teach this. The Board is one. Each affected Data Principal is the other. A bank that informs only its regulator-style mailing list and never the customers whose statements were exposed has not pictured section 8. A bank that publishes a homepage banner and does not address the people affected has the same gap. Affected means their personal data was compromised, not every person who once walked past a branch. Build a way to produce that list from your systems. Doing so now is preparation. Saying the letters are already legally due on the review date is not.

4

Containment is not the same document as intimation. Stop the sharing, revoke the link, reset the exposed credential, and keep a record of what you saw. Those steps protect people and they are recommendations you should not delay until 2027. A hospital that leaves an open folder online because 'the duty has not commenced' is confusing a commencement date with basic care. Close the folder. Then, in the incident note, write a second sentence: statutory intimation to the Board and to affected Data Principals commences on 13 May 2027, in the form and manner prescribed. Two sentences, two ideas. Boards understand that split.

5

The penalty row for not notifying is up to Rs 200 crore. Say up to. The Board imposes it after inquiry, when the penalty provisions are in force. It is not a tariff a consultant can invoice, and it is not added automatically to the security row. Failure of reasonable security safeguards is a separate maximum of up to Rs 250 crore. One messy incident might, after 13 May 2027, raise both questions: were safeguards reasonable, and was intimation given as prescribed? On 2 October 2026 neither question is an enforceable penalty. Do not let a draft press release say the company has already been fined.

6

Decide roles before the night of an incident. Who is the internal lead, who talks to the processor,

who drafts the explanation to people, and who checks that you are not announcing a statutory filing that has not commenced? A processor who sees the breach first still sits under a fiduciary that remains responsible once section 8 is in force. Put a clause in the vendor contract, as a recommendation, that the vendor tells you promptly. That clause is not the Act's 72-hour rule, because the Act has none. A marketplace, for example, can require its app vendor to phone the privacy desk the same day an admin token leaks, and can keep the statutory form for the 2027 commencement.

7

Write the explanation in human language. Say what happened, what data was involved, and what you are doing about it, without a lecture on every Schedule row. If you do not yet know the edge of the file, say what you know and what you are still checking. Over-claiming is how incident notes become new problems. Do not tell people they must complain within 72 hours or lose a DPDP right. Grievance timing is a prescribed period under section 13, not a slogan. And do not call your incident software the Data Protection Board. Consent Guru can help an organisation track notices and choices. It is not the Board, and it is not a registered Consent Manager.

8

Close the module with a card the incident lead can read under pressure. Classify using section 2. Contain the incident. List who is affected. Do not start a 72-hour statutory timer, because the Act does not set one. When section 8 is in force, intimate the Board and each affected Data Principal in the form and manner prescribed. The failure-to-notify maximum of up to Rs 200 crore commences on 13 May 2027 and is not a live fine on 2 October 2026. For example, clip that card to the on-call rota. This is education, not a finding about a real breach, and it is not legal advice.

Module 22

Significant Data Fiduciaries

About 12 minutes

1

Significant sounds like a compliment. In this Act it is a notified status. Section 10 allows the Central Government to notify any Data Fiduciary or class of Data Fiduciaries as a Significant Data Fiduciary, on an assessment of relevant factors. A fintech founder who adds the words to her email signature has not completed that process. The signature is marketing. The notification is law. Section 10 commences on 13 May 2027. On the review date, 2 October 2026, do not describe any organisation as an SDF under a live section 10.

2

Read the factors as the government's checklist, not yours. They include the volume and sensitivity of personal data processed, the risk to the rights of the Data Principal, the potential impact on the sovereignty and integrity of India, risk to electoral democracy, security of the State, and public order. A platform that holds voter-related files and a clinic that holds health files may both look sensitive, and sensitivity alone still does not complete the notification. The Act does not say 'more than one million users' or any other figure. If a slide invents a threshold, take the number off. You would be inventing a rule the statute did not write.

3

Class notifications are possible and they are still notifications. The government may notify a class, not only a named company. That does not mean you may declare your sector a class. 'All schools' or 'all banks' is not an SDF list unless the gazette says so. A principal who hears a conference rumour should ask for the notification number. If there is none, the school remains an ordinary Data Fiduciary if it determines the purpose and means of processing. That ordinary status already has a definition, in section 2, in force since 13 November 2025. Additional SDF obligations are a later layer.

4

Do not let size panic replace the text. A very large retailer is not an SDF because its revenue is large. A small company handling a particularly sensitive government database is not exempt from the possibility of notification merely because the headcount is low. The government assesses the factors. Your job is to watch the gazette and not to pre-empt it. Meanwhile, prepare for the section 8 duties that apply to fiduciaries generally from 13 May 2027: security, breach intimation in the prescribed form and manner, accuracy where decisions are made, and a real contact person. Those are not SDF-only.

5

The extra obligations are real, and they wait for both the date and the notification. Once a fiduciary is notified, and once section 10 is in force, it must appoint an India-based Data Protection Officer, appoint an independent data auditor, and undertake periodic data protection impact assessment and periodic audit, plus other measures as prescribed. The next module teaches those duties. This module's point is the gate. A company that builds an India-based privacy office early may be making a sensible recommendation. It should not announce that the office proves SDF status. Status is the government's act.

6

Penalties follow the same discipline. The Schedule maximum for breach of the additional obligations of a Significant Data Fiduciary is up to Rs 150 crore. It is a maximum, not an automatic fine, and the

penalty provisions commence on 13 May 2027. It is the wrong figure to quote at a business that has not been notified. It is also the wrong figure for a security failure, which has its own maximum of up to Rs 250 crore, or for a children's breach, up to Rs 200 crore. Keep the rows straight so a board is not shown one number for every fear.

7

Vendors will offer 'SDF registration packages.' There is no self-registration in section 10. Consent Manager registration, which is a different institution under section 6(9) and section 27(1)(d), is itself not in force until 13 November 2026, and it does not make the applicant an SDF. A product such as Consent Guru does not notify anybody. If a sales call blurs SDF status, Consent Manager registration, and ordinary fiduciary duties, separate the three on a whiteboard. For example, write three columns and put the commencement date under each. That ten-minute exercise prevents an expensive confusion.

8

End with the sentence a general counsel can give the chief executive. We are a Data Fiduciary where we decide purpose and means. We are a Significant Data Fiduciary only if the Central Government notifies us under section 10. That section commences on 13 May 2027, and no internal policy can replace the notification. For example, use the sentence to correct a pitch deck before it goes to investors. This module is education. It is not a prediction of who the government will notify, and it is not legal advice on a draft notification you have not actually been served.

Module 23**Additional Obligations of Significant Data Fiduciaries**

About 12 minutes

1

Additional means additional. The duties in this module sit on top of ordinary fiduciary obligations, and only for a Data Fiduciary the Central Government has notified under section 10. The first is a Data Protection Officer who represents the SDF under the Act, is based in India, is responsible to the board of directors or a similar governing body, and is the point of contact for grievance redressal. A global group with a privacy counsel only in another country has not met the 'based in India' limb. Section 10 commences on 13 May 2027. A notification is still required. Both conditions are easy to skip in a hurry.

2

The officer is a point of contact, not a decoration. When a Data Principal uses the grievance path, the SDF's Data Protection Officer is who section 10 identifies. That links to section 13, which also commences on 13 May 2027 and which requires a readily available means of redress before a person approaches the Board. Publish a contact that reaches this person. An inbox nobody reads is a weak match for a statutory point of contact. A non-SDF still publishes a person who can answer, under section 8, but should not borrow the SDF title. Say 'privacy contact' unless you are actually notified.

3

The independent data auditor evaluates compliance. The Act asks the SDF to appoint that auditor to carry out a data audit. Independence is there so the audit is an evaluation, not a reprint of the team's own dashboard. A company secretary signing a one-line note that says 'we comply' is not the picture. The Act does not name a mandatory firm, and this course will not invent a panel. Choosing a capable external reviewer can be a recommendation even before notification. Calling the reviewer 'our statutory SDF auditor' before section 10 and a notification exist would overclaim. On 2 October 2026, do not say the appointment is already a commenced duty.

4

Periodic data protection impact assessment is a structured look at risk to people's rights. The Act describes it as including the rights of Data Principals, the purpose of processing, and the assessment and management of risk to those rights, plus matters that may be prescribed. A notified platform about to launch a new use of sensitive files would be the classic candidate, once the duty applies. Periodic audit sits beside it, and other measures may be prescribed. Because the word is periodic, do not invent 'every March' as the statutory frequency. The prescribing rules commence on 13 May 2027. An internal yearly drill can be a recommendation if you label the calendar as yours.

5

Keep section 8 in the SDF story. Notification does not excuse safeguards, processor contracts, accuracy of decision data, erasure, or breach intimation in the form and manner prescribed. An SDF that publishes a beautiful assessment and leaves a database open has not finished the Act. The intimation rule still has no 72-hour clock in the statute. The Schedule then uses different maxima: up to Rs 150 crore for the additional SDF obligations, up to Rs 250 crore for failure of reasonable security safeguards, up to Rs 200 crore for failure to notify a breach. Teach the rows. All of them are maxima, and all of them commence on 13 May 2027.

6

Transfer questions sometimes get stapled to SDF status without care. Section 16, which you will

meet soon, allows the Central Government to restrict transfers to territories it notifies. It is not a whitelist and not a general ban, and it commences on 13 May 2027. If the government later prescribes a further SDF measure about a specified dataset, you will follow that prescription because it is prescribed, not because a rumour said all SDF data must stay in one building. Do not tell an engineering team to redesign a global architecture on a localisation rule you cannot point to in a commenced instrument. Ask for the instrument.

7

Non-SDF organisations should not feel the module is irrelevant, and they should not feel accused. A hospital that is not notified can still name an owner, assess a new paediatric system, and test its safeguards. Those are good recommendations under the ordinary duties that commence on 13 May 2027. The mistake is the letterhead. Do not write 'Significant Data Fiduciary' on the letterhead to sound serious. For example, a 200-bed hospital can have a privacy committee and a clear parent-consent plan for children without claiming section 10 status. Children's duties in section 9 apply to fiduciaries, not only to SDFs, and they share the same commencement date.

8

Close with a gate and a list. Gate: are we notified, and has 13 May 2027 arrived? If both answers become yes, appoint the India-based Data Protection Officer answerable to the governing body, appoint an independent data auditor, and run the periodic assessment and audit in the prescribed way. If either answer is no, do not claim the statutory SDF duties are live. The maximum of up to Rs 150 crore is not a fine on the review date. For example, put the gate at the top of the privacy roadmap so a tool purchase is not mistaken for a notification. This module is education, not a finding that your company has been notified.

Module 24

Data Protection Board of India

About 13 minutes

1

The Data Protection Board of India is the institution the Act builds to do the jobs the Act lists. Sections 18 to 26 deal with establishment, who may be appointed, how the Board sits, and related institutional points. Notification G.S.R. 843(E) brought those sections into force on 13 November 2025. On 2 October 2026 it is correct to say the Board's institutional provisions are in force. It is not correct to slide from that sentence into 'so every penalty is already being collected.' A logistics company asking 'does the Board exist in the statute yet?' can be told yes, the establishment chapter has commenced, and the enforcement duties have a later date.

2

Functions live mainly in section 27, and the notification divides them. Section 27(1)(d) is the Consent Manager registration function, and it commences on 13 November 2026, with section 6(9) and Rule 4. The rest of section 27 commences on 13 May 2027. That later set is where inquiry and the Board's enforcement work around fiduciary duties belong. If a slide shows one date for 'the Board,' break the slide in two. Registration of a special kind of person is not the same event as a penalty for a missing safeguard. On the review date, registration has not started, and neither has the penalty work.

3

Penalties are a Board act when the penalty provisions commence, not a customer-service script. The Schedule states maxima: up to Rs 10,000 for Data Principal duties, up to Rs 250 crore for security safeguards, up to Rs 200 crore for children's provisions, up to Rs 200 crore for failure to notify a breach, up to Rs 150 crore for additional SDF obligations, and up to Rs 50 crore for other provisions. The Board considers the case. The sums are ceilings. None of those penalty provisions is in force on 2 October 2026. Quoting them as today's invoice misunderstands both the Schedule and G.S.R. 843(E).

4

Procedure, appeals, and voluntary undertakings are in the later tranche. Sections 28 to 34 commence on 13 May 2027. Section 29 provides an appeal to the Telecom Disputes Settlement and Appellate Tribunal. That is the appellate body. Do not substitute a high court in your diagram unless you are talking about a different jurisdiction the Act actually states, and do not invent a limitation period. A voluntary undertaking is an enacted mechanism in that procedure chapter. It is not a product, and it is not a way to 'settle' a DPDP penalty on the review date, because the penalty machinery has not commenced. Say what the Act provides, and say when.

5

Digital working is part of how the procedure chapter is designed, and you should not over-describe provisions whose details you have not opened. What you can say safely is that the Board is a statutory body with its own establishment provisions already in force, and that the way inquiries and appeals run is appointed for 13 May 2027. A training story that claims a particular portal, password, or filing fee is 'already mandatory' is guessing. Check the commenced rules. Rules 17 to 21 came into force on 13 November 2025 and belong with institutional machinery. Rules about notices, breaches, and the operational duties commence on 13 May 2027. Match the rule to the date.

6

People confuse the Board with everyone else who touches privacy. The Board is not the Data

Fiduciary, not the Data Principal, and not a Consent Manager. A Consent Manager is a person the Board registers. Your own grievance desk is not the Board, even though section 13 will require the Data Principal to use that desk before she approaches the Board. Consent Guru is software an organisation may use. It is not the Board, and it is not a registered Consent Manager. If a website footer says 'appeals may be filed with Consent Guru,' replace it. Appeals under section 29 go to the TDSAT, and only once that section has commenced.

7

Use the review date as a drill. Ask a manager three questions. Which Board provisions are already in force? Which Board function starts on 13 November 2026? Which functions and appeals start on 13 May 2027? The answers are sections 18 to 26 now, Consent Manager registration next, and the rest of section 27 plus penalties and TDSAT appeals on 13 May 2027. A bank compliance team can put those three lines on a single card. The card stops a well-meaning email that tells a customer to 'escalate to the Board's penalty bench' in October 2026. There is no such live bench for those fiduciary penalties yet.

8

Close without pretending the Board is either imaginary or all-powerful today. It is established in the statute, the institutional sections have commenced, and the heavy enforcement functions wait until 13 May 2027, except the registration function that waits until 13 November 2026. For example, a public FAQ can say exactly that, and can tell people to use the company's contact for present complaints as customer service. This module is education. It is not a prediction of how the Board will decide a future case, and it is not legal advice on whether to file anything.

Module 25

Penalties and Enforcement

About 14 minutes

1

Penalties frighten people into remembering the wrong number. Start with the Schedule as a set of ceilings. Up to Rs 10,000 for breach of a Data Principal's duties under section 15. Up to Rs 250 crore for failure to take reasonable security safeguards. Up to Rs 200 crore for the children's provisions. Up to Rs 200 crore for failure to notify a personal data breach. Up to Rs 150 crore for the additional obligations of a Significant Data Fiduciary. Up to Rs 50 crore for breach of the other provisions. Say up to, every time. A clinic and a bank should hear the same ceilings. What changes is which row could even apply, and only after the penalty provisions commence.

2

The Board imposes the penalty. A shop, a processor, a software tool, and a social-media post do not. The Board looks at the case. The Act points it to factors such as nature, gravity, and duration, the kind of personal data, repetition, gain or avoided loss, and mitigation. That is why a quickly contained incident and a months-long open database are not twins. This course will not invent a formula that multiplies the maximum by a percentage. If you need a number for a live matter after commencement, you need the Board's process, not a spreadsheet you made in training. On 2 October 2026 you do not need a number at all, because the penalty provisions are not in force.

3

Commencement is the part finance teams miss. Notification G.S.R. 843(E) puts the penalty provisions in the 13 May 2027 tranche, with sections 28 to 34 and the enforcement side of section 27, other than Consent Manager registration. The Board's institutional sections have been in force since 13 November 2025. A sentence such as 'the Board exists, therefore fines are running' joins two different dates. Correct it in the risk register. Write 'enacted maximum, not commenced' next to each row. A listed company that discloses a present DPDP penalty liability on the review date, without a commenced provision, is describing a debt the notification has not created.

4

Match the row to the conduct so the largest number is not used as a universal threat. Weak safeguards point to the Rs 250 crore maximum. A failure to intimate the Board and affected people, in the prescribed form and manner, points to the Rs 200 crore notification maximum. Children's tracking or a missing verifiable consent points to the children's maximum, also up to Rs 200 crore. An SDF that skips the India-based Data Protection Officer or the independent audit, after it has actually been notified, points to the Rs 150 crore maximum. A Data Principal who impersonates someone points to Rs 10,000, not to a crore. Other provisions sit under the Rs 50 crore maximum. One poster with only the biggest number trains people to threaten.

5

Nothing here is automatic. The Schedule does not say the maximum is inflicted on the day an email is mis-sent. It does not say the company may collect Rs 10,000 from a complaining customer. It does not say two maxima are added as a single mandatory sum. A retailer that wants a 'standard DPDP charge' on its invoice is inventing a private tax. Remove it. After 13 May 2027, if there is ever a penalty, it will be the Board's order, up to the relevant maximum, after inquiry. Appeals from the Board go to the Telecom Disputes Settlement and Appellate Tribunal under section 29, which commences on the same date. Do not sketch that appeal as open on the review date.

6

Do not smuggle a 72-hour penalty into the Schedule. The Act's breach-intimation duty uses the form and manner prescribed. GDPR's 72-hour authority rule is not a DPDP row and not a DPDP clock. A policy that says 'miss 72 hours and the Rs 200 crore fine is automatic' is wrong twice: wrong clock, wrong idea of a maximum. You may still escalate inside the company immediately. Label that as an internal control. For example, a bank can require the incident lead to brief the privacy head the same day, and can state in the same paragraph that statutory intimation and any penalty commence on 13 May 2027.

7

Preparation is rational precisely because the maxima are large and the date is known. Improve safeguards, plan intimation without a fake deadline, design children's journeys, and do not call yourself an SDF without a notification. Those steps do not pay a fine, because no fine is due on 2 October 2026. They reduce the chance that, after commencement, the Board is looking at a neglected system. A voluntary undertaking, once the procedure chapter is in force, is one mechanism the Act provides. It is not a coupon you can buy from a vendor, and it is not a reason to overstate your compliance in a public claim. Keep the undertaking in the 'later tranche' column.

8

Leave with a spoken summary a director can repeat. The Schedule sets maxima, not automatic fines. The largest security maximum is up to Rs 250 crore. The Board decides. Nothing in that list is being enforced on 2 October 2026. The date to write down is 13 May 2027. For example, put that summary on the first page of the risk paper and move war stories to an appendix. This module is education. It is not a calculation of your exposure, and it is not legal advice on a real incident or on what to tell a regulator.

Module 26

Cross-Border Data Transfers

About 11 minutes

1

Cross-border questions arrive as slogans: data must never leave, or data may go anywhere our vendor likes. Section 16 is neither slogan. It says the Central Government may, by notification, restrict the transfer of personal data by a Data Fiduciary for processing to such country or territory outside India as may be so notified. The action is a restriction. The target is a territory the government names. A software firm backing up employee files to a foreign region should watch for a notification about that region. It should not announce a ban the gazette has not made. Section 16 commences on 13 May 2027.

2

There is no whitelist hiding in the section. A whitelist would be a list of places you are told you may send data. Section 16 does not publish that list. It publishes a power to restrict. If someone hands you a chart titled 'DPDP approved countries' with flags and no notification number, set the chart aside. On 2 October 2026 the section is not even in force, so a chart of approved destinations is doubly early. The same discipline kills a fake blacklist. Do not name a country as banned in your training unless you can point to the government notification that restricts it.

3

GDPR transfer tools are a common import. Adequacy decisions and standard contractual clauses are how another law talks about exports. They are not section 16. You may still use a contract with a foreign processor because, when section 8 commences, a fiduciary may engage a processor only under a valid contract. That contract is about the processor relationship and the fiduciary's responsibility. It is not a Central Government notification under section 16, and it does not whitelist a country. Keep the documents in different folders so a procurement manager does not think a signed order form is the gazette.

4

The processing still needs a ground. Moving a file across a border is processing. Once sections 4, 6, and 7 are in force, you still need a lawful purpose and either consent or a certain legitimate use. A foreign analytics project is not lawful merely because no section 16 notification exists yet. If you want to send a customer's contacts to an overseas advertiser, ask whether she consented to that specified purpose, or whether a listed legitimate use actually fits. Legitimate interest, in the GDPR sense, is still not a DPDP ground. All of these sections commence on 13 May 2027. Map them together rather than letting the transfer question swallow the purpose question.

5

Processors abroad do not stop being processors. If the foreign company hosts the database on your instructions and for your purpose, it is a Data Processor. You remain responsible under section 8 when that section commences, and you must be able to cause erasure when erasure is required. If the foreign company mines the file for its own products, it is determining a purpose. Say so in the transfer map. An Indian ed-tech firm, for example, can note 'video host in Country A, on our instructions' in one row and 'optional research use the host wants for itself' in another row. Only the first row is a clean processor transfer.

6

SDF rumours should not redesign your network by themselves. Section 10's additional duties are the India-based Data Protection Officer, the independent auditor, and periodic assessment and

audit, after a notification. If a further transfer measure is prescribed for a notified SDF, you will follow the prescription you can read. You will not follow a hallway comment that 'all SDF data is banned from leaving India.' Section 16 remains the general restriction power, and it is territory-specific. Both sections commence on 13 May 2027. A global architecture review can be a recommendation. Label it as engineering prudence, not as a commenced localisation mandate you cannot cite.

7

Build the map before the date, and keep it humble. Columns that help are the dataset, the purpose, the recipient, the country or region, the contract, and a blank column for a section 16 notification if one ever names that territory. A hospital group using an overseas teleradiology vendor can fill the row for scans and names. The blank notification column is a feature, not an omission. It stops the policy from pretending a restriction exists. Review the gazette when you review the vendor. On the review date, write at the top of the map that section 16 is not yet in force.

8

Close with the two sentences that prevent a bad policy rewrite. The Act does not impose a general ban on transfers out of India, and it does not hand you a whitelist. It lets the Central Government restrict transfers to notified territories, from 13 May 2027. For example, delete a footer that says 'we only send data to approved DPDP countries' unless you are describing your own commercial choice and you say it is your choice, not section 16. This module is education. It is not a clearance for a particular country's servers, and it is not legal advice on a live vendor migration.

Module 27**Data Retention, Deletion and Lifecycle Management**

About 12 minutes

1

Retention is where good privacy programmes either become real or become a slogan. Section 8 tells the Data Fiduciary to erase personal data, unless a law requires it to be kept, when the Data Principal withdraws consent or as soon as it is reasonable to assume the specified purpose is no longer being served, whichever is earlier. The same erasure must reach the Data Processor. A travel agency that collected a passport scan to issue one visa, and that has finished that work, should be asking why the scan is still in a shared folder. The duty commences on 13 May 2027. Asking the question now is preparation.

2

Specified purpose is the anchor. If the notice said the phone number is for delivery updates, the lifecycle of that use ends when delivery updates are over, unless she consented to something else or a legitimate use on the section 7 list really applies. It does not end 'when we feel like it' and it does not continue because the field might be useful for a new idea. New idea, new purpose, new ground. A grocery app can keep the number through the day's deliveries and should not quietly fold it into a permanent broker feed. Sections 5, 7, and 8 commence together on 13 May 2027. Design the end date with the start date.

3

The deeming rule stops files living on polite neglect. If she does not come back for the specified purpose, and does not exercise her rights, for such time as may be prescribed, the purpose is deemed no longer served. Prescribed is the word you must not replace. This course will not say three years, one year, or 72 hours. The rules that can set the period commence on 13 May 2027. A company standard that deletes inactive promotional contacts after an internal period can be sensible, if the standard says internal. A notice that says 'the Act deems purpose over in 72 hours' is false. Take that sentence out before it ships.

4

Legal retention is the adult exception. Tax invoices, certain employment records, and sector files may have to be kept because another law says so. Section 8 yields to compliance with any law in force. It does not yield to curiosity. When you claim the exception, name the law and the record. A hospital that must keep a treatment file under a health-record rule should cite that rule for that file, and should not use it to justify keeping a marketing spreadsheet of ex-patients. Section 12 says the same kind of thing about erasure requests: retain if the specified purpose still needs it or the law requires it. Both sections commence on 13 May 2027.

5

Withdrawal has its own phrase. Section 6 says cease processing within a reasonable time, and cause processors to cease, unless the Act or another law still requires or authorises the processing. Reasonable time is not a number you may invent, and it is not the GDPR 72-hour breach clock. A magazine that receives 'stop the promotional emails' should stop that use and tell its email vendor to stop. It may keep a subscription invoice if a law requires the invoice. Explain the split to the reader in one paragraph. Do not hide the invoice inside the mailing list, and do not hide the mailing list inside the invoice. On the review date, build the split. Do not call it an already enforced duty.

6

Processors and backups are where lifecycle projects stall. If the fiduciary must erase, the processor

must erase too. A backup that restores the deleted file next Tuesday has not really erased it. A recommendation is to know how backups age out, and to write that into the vendor contract before 13 May 2027. You do not need to pretend the contract clause is already a statutory breach if it is missing on 2 October 2026. You do need a plan. An insurer, for example, can ask its cloud vendor how a deleted policyholder phone number leaves active systems and backups, and can record the answer as preparation rather than as a completed section 8 audit.

7

Do not use a foreign ground to keep data you should not keep. GDPR legitimate interest is not a DPDP reason for an indefinite archive. Certain legitimate uses are the Act's list, and they are specific. Employment records that fall inside the employment use still do not justify a side database of employee contacts sold to a retailer. Children's data has a further constraint: section 9 will restrict tracking and targeted advertising directed at children, so a 'keep everything for ads' lifecycle is the wrong design for a minor. Those sections share the 13 May 2027 date. A school app should plan a short life for a parent's promotional flag and a legally grounded life for a fee receipt, and should not mix the two.

8

Finish with a schedule a team can actually fill. Dataset, purpose, system, processor, legal hold if any, deletion trigger, and a note that section 8 commences on 13 May 2027. For example, a retailer fills one row for open orders and another for a festival marketing list that should die when consent is withdrawn. Leave the prescribed inactivity period blank until the rule commences, rather than inventing it. This module is education. It does not tell you the retention year in your tax statute, and it is not legal advice on whether a particular file must be kept for a dispute.

Module 28**Consent Management and Practical CMP Implementation**

About 13 minutes

1

A consent banner is a screen. A Consent Manager is a legal person with a registration. Section 2 defines that person as someone registered with the Board, a single point of contact for giving, managing, reviewing, and withdrawing consent on an accessible, transparent, and interoperable platform. Your own banner, however polished, is the Data Fiduciary talking to its own user. It is not that registered person. Section 6(9) registration commences on 13 November 2026, with section 27(1)(d) and Rule 4. On 2 October 2026 it is not in force. If a launch plan says 'we go live as a Consent Manager on Friday,' stop the plan.

2

Consent Guru needs a plain description. It is software an organisation can use to present a notice and keep a record of choices about the organisation's processing. That can be useful preparation. It does not register Consent Guru with the Board, and it does not register the organisation. A footer that says 'Consent Guru, your registered Consent Manager' is inaccurate. Replace it with language such as 'consent tool used by this organisation.' A client who hears the wrong title in a demo will repeat it to customers. Fix the demo script. The correction is not a criticism of having a tool. It is a refusal to borrow a statutory title early.

3

Design the adult journey against sections 5 and 6, and date it. The notice should say what data you want and why, how rights will be exercised, and how a complaint to the Board may be made. The choice should be a clear affirmative action, specific to a purpose, not bundled so that a necessary delivery consent drags in an unnecessary sale of data. Withdrawal should be as easy as the original tap. A streaming app that hides 'stop recommendations' behind a postal form, after a one-tap opt-in, is the example to rebuild. These standards commence on 13 May 2027. The rebuild is preparation. Do not badge the screen 'already enforced.'

4

The record is how you will carry the burden of proof. When section 6 is in force, if someone asks whether notice was given and consent was valid, the Data Fiduciary must prove it. A CMP that stores the text shown, the time, and the action taken is aimed at that burden. A CMP that stores only a green icon is not. Write down what you keep, and for which purpose. Keeping the record is a recommendation on the review date, because the burden has not commenced. It is also the difference between a tool and a screenshot. Do not keep the record forever without a purpose. Lifecycle rules in section 8 will apply to consent logs too, from 13 May 2027, unless a law requires retention.

5

Language and contact details are part of the same build. Section 5 requires an option to access the notice in English or an Eighth Schedule language. Section 6's request is in clear and plain language and gives a contact for questions. A single English paragraph of jargon fails both aims. A bank that serves customers in more than one language should plan the toggle before commencement, without claiming Rule 3 is already in force. Rule 3 commences on 13 May 2027. Publish a real person who can answer, which section 8 will require. If you are not a notified SDF, do not call that person the statutory Data Protection Officer under section 10.

6

Do not add a fake ground to the banner. A toggle labelled legitimate interest is a GDPR control, not a DPDP one. If you are relying on a certain legitimate use, such as the address the customer just typed for the delivery she asked for, you do not need to dress that use up as a foreign balancing test. If you want a separate festival promotion, ask for specific consent. Pre-ticked boxes are not a clear affirmative action. A jewellery site that pre-ticks 'share with partners' is the scene to unpick. Section 7 and section 6 commence on 13 May 2027. Until then, a clean banner is a recommendation, not a commenced defence.

7

Children do not go through the adult CMP unchanged. Section 2 says a child has not completed eighteen years. Section 9 will require verifiable parental or guardian consent and will prohibit tracking, behavioural monitoring, and targeted advertising directed at children. A checkbox saying 'I am 13 or older' imports the wrong age and the wrong consent. Build a separate path, and do not let the advertising profile run for that user. The Rs 200 crore children's maximum is not in force on the review date, and it is a maximum, not a reason to skip the design. For example, a revision app can stop the ad tag when the date of birth shows seventeen, and can note that section 9 commences on 13 May 2027.

8

Ship a checklist a product manager can hold. Are we calling ourselves a registered Consent Manager? If yes, stop; registration is not open on 2 October 2026, and Consent Guru is not one. Does each optional purpose have its own action and an easy withdrawal? Can we prove what was shown? Is there a child path aimed at eighteen, not thirteen? Are the statutory duties labelled as commencing on 13 May 2027? For example, walk the checklist on a staging site before a campaign. This module is education. It does not certify a banner as compliant, and it is not legal advice on the wording of a live campaign.

Module 29**Building a DPDP Compliance Program**

About 14 minutes

1

A compliance programme is how a busy organisation remembers the Act on a Tuesday. It is not a single policy PDF. Start with an inventory of digital personal data. A college can list admissions forms, fee records, hostel gate logs, and alumni emails, and can mark which rows identify a child or a parent. Section 2's definitions are already in force, so the labels Data Principal, Data Fiduciary, and Data Processor can be used today. The inventory does not make section 8 enforceable early. It is a recommendation that will feed every later control. On 2 October 2026, write 'preparation' on the cover so nobody files the inventory as a completed statutory return.

2

Role mapping is the second page. Who decides the purpose? That organisation is the Data Fiduciary. Who only hosts or sends on instruction? That organisation is the Data Processor. If a vendor wants the data for its own model, give that flow a fiduciary label of its own. Do not add a third crown called Significant Data Fiduciary unless a Central Government notification under section 10 exists. Do not add a fourth crown called Consent Manager unless someone is actually registered, which cannot have happened yet on the review date. A manufacturer, for example, may be fiduciary for dealer contacts and processor for a brand principal's warranty file. The map should show both. Section 10 commences on 13 May 2027. Registration commences on 13 November 2026.

3

Grounds and notices are the third page. For each purpose, write consent or the section 7 use, in the Act's words, not 'legitimate interest.' Draft the notice with data, purpose, rights, and the complaint path. Plan a clear affirmative action and a withdrawal that is as easy as the yes. Keep the record you will need when the burden of proof in section 6 commences. A bank can separate 'send this account alert' from 'send a partner's credit-card offer.' The alert may sit close to the service. The offer needs its own consent design. Sections 4, 5, 6, and 7 commence on 13 May 2027. The drafts are preparation. They are not a declaration that enforcement has begun.

4

Children, rights, and contacts are the customer-facing half. Use eighteen as the age. Plan verifiable parent or guardian consent and do not build tracking ads aimed at children. Sketch access, correction, erasure, grievance, and nomination, and leave prescribed timelines blank rather than inventing them. Name a person who can answer. If you are not a notified SDF, that person is your contact under the future section 8 duty, not a section 10 Data Protection Officer. A gaming company can put these four items on one roadmap and date section 9 and sections 11 to 14 to 13 May 2027. The roadmap should also say the children's penalty maximum is up to Rs 200 crore, not automatic, and not in force on the review date.

5

Security and incidents are where programmes either protect people or perform paperwork. Choose safeguards that match the data: access control, protection of stored identity files, and a check on who your processor lets in. Those examples are recommendations, not a statutory shopping list. Write the incident card in the words of section 8: tell the Board and each affected Data Principal, in the form and manner prescribed, when the duty is in force. Cross out 72 hours if it appears as a DPDP rule. A hospital group can run a tabletop that stops at 'draft the explanation' and does not pretend a filing is legally due today. The safeguard maximum of up to Rs 250 crore and the

notification maximum of up to Rs 200 crore commence on 13 May 2027.

6

Vendors, retention, and transfers keep the programme from living only in the privacy team's folder. Every processor needs a contract path before section 8 commences: purpose, safeguards, help on an incident, and deletion. The retention schedule cites a real law or an internal rule, never a made-up statutory year. The transfer map has a blank column for a section 16 restriction notification, because the Act is not a whitelist and not a general ban. A retailer can review its top ten vendors against those three pages in a month. Mark the work preparation. A missing clause on 2 October 2026 is a gap to close, not a commenced penalty. Say that in the procurement minutes so the commercial team is not misled.

7

Governance and training stop the programme rotting. Name an owner. Meet often enough to look at new products. Teach support staff the duties in section 15 without turning Rs 10,000 into a threat, and teach them that rights are not yet enforceable. Teach product staff that Consent Guru is a tool, not a registered Consent Manager and not the Board. A quarterly hour for a 300-person firm can cover one module's mistakes, such as a pre-ticked box or an SDF claim in a press note. The training deck's first line should repeat the review date and the two future dates. If the deck is titled 'we are already certified,' change the title. This course does not certify anyone.

8

Sequence the last page like a calendar, not a wish. From now until 13 November 2026, build the machinery and do not claim Consent Manager registration. On and after that date, registration is a specific legal step for a person who will be a Consent Manager, not a sticker for a banner. From now until 13 May 2027, finish the operational artefacts, knowing they are preparation. On that date, sections 3 to 17, most Board enforcement, appeals, and penalties are appointed to commence. For example, put those sentences in the board pack instead of a red-amber-green that hides the gazette. This module is education. It is not legal advice that your programme is sufficient.

Module 30

DPDP Compliance in Real-World Organizations - Final Practical Module

About 13 minutes

1

This last module leaves the classroom and walks into five ordinary organisations. Keep the calendar in your pocket. Today, for this course, is 2 October 2026. Section 2 and the Board's institutional provisions have been in force since 13 November 2025. Consent Manager registration starts on 13 November 2026 and has not started. The duties that change forms, ads, security programmes, and breach letters start on 13 May 2027. A founder who wants a single word, 'live' or 'not live,' is asking the wrong question. Say which section. Then apply it to the scene in front of you. The scenes are education, not a ruling on a real company.

2

Take a food-delivery app. It decides why it collects a phone number and an address, so it is the Data Fiduciary. The cloud company that only hosts the database is a processor. Using the address to deliver the meal the customer ordered is the kind of voluntary provision section 7 describes, if she has not indicated that she does not consent to that use. A separate 'offers from restaurants you have never heard of' programme is a consent design, not a legitimate-interest checkbox. The app's banner is not a Consent Manager, and Consent Guru, if they use it, is not one either. If a seventeen-year-old can open an account, the children's rules in section 9 are on the future build list. None of those operational duties is being enforced today.

3

Take a hospital. A medical emergency, an epidemic response, or treatment during a public-health threat can fall inside section 7's listed uses when the facts match the words. That is not permission to sell patient lists to a wellness brand. Security of health data is a section 8 problem from 13 May 2027, with a safeguards maximum of up to Rs 250 crore that is not automatic and not in force now. If a laptop of discharge summaries goes missing, classify it with the section 2 definition, contain it, and do not start a statutory 72-hour clock. A patient who is a child still brings section 9, through the parent or guardian. The hospital does not become an SDF because the data is sensitive. Sensitivity is a factor the government may consider. Notification is the act that confers the status.

4

Take a school and an employer, because people mix them. A pupil who has not completed eighteen is a child. The school should plan verifiable parent or guardian consent and should not run behavioural ads at pupils. A parent writing about the child's file is not a stranger under section 2. An employer processing payroll, or protecting a trade secret, can study the employment use in section 7. An employer selling staff phone numbers to a retailer cannot hide in that use. Staff duties under section 15, such as not impersonating a colleague in a request, commence with the rights on 13 May 2027, and the maximum is up to Rs 10,000, not a crore and not a deduction the payroll team may invent. Write the school story and the employer story on separate pages so the age rule and the employment rule do not blur.

5

Take a marketplace where a platform and thousands of sellers share one order. Ask who determines the purpose. If the platform decides to keep the buyer's number for delivery coordination across sellers, the platform is a fiduciary for that processing. If a seller downloads the number and starts an

unrelated WhatsApp campaign, the seller is determining a new purpose. A processor clause in the seller contract, once section 8 is in force, does not convert that campaign back into 'on behalf of the platform.' Grievances need a path people can find, and the customer must use it before the Board once section 13 commences. On the review date, build the path as service and as preparation. Do not tell the buyer the Board is already fining the seller.

6

The same five organisations share the same failure modes. Someone will add 72 hours to the breach card. Someone will declare the firm an SDF in a pitch. Someone will call the banner a registered Consent Manager. Someone will add every Schedule maximum into one frightening total. Someone will copy a GDPR country whitelist into the cross-border paragraph. The correction is always the same shape. Name the section. Name the date in G.S.R. 843(E). If the date is 13 May 2027, call the work preparation. If you cannot find a notification, do not invent an SDF label or a banned country. A fifteen-minute red-team of your own website footer will find at least one of these sentences if the footer was written in a hurry.

7

What 'good' looks like on the review date is modest and useful. You can point to an inventory. You can say who the fiduciary is. You can show a draft notice that states a real purpose. You can show a child path aimed at eighteen. You can show a vendor list and a deletion note that does not fake a statutory year. You can show an incident card without a false clock. You can tell the board the rupee maxima are ceilings that commence on 13 May 2027. A housing-finance company that can do those seven things is ahead of a company that owns a thicker policy and a wrong date. Neither company should claim it has been audited by this course. Training is not an audit.

8

End where the first module began. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 is Act 22 of 2023, assented to on 11 August 2023, and commenced in stages by Notification G.S.R. 843(E). The Rules, 2025 were notified by G.S.R. 846(E). Learn the words, respect the dates, and prepare for 13 May 2027 without pretending that day has already arrived. For example, the last line of your internal FAQ can be: this training is educational, it is not legal advice, and a live decision needs the Act, the Rules, the latest gazette, and qualified advice. If a later notification restricts a territory or changes a date, follow that instrument. The course has given you a map. It has not walked your file to the Board.